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Piedmont Post

A Community Newspaper Serving the Citizens of Piedmont

City Council appoints Bonnie Tam as next Public Works Director

By Jake Lannon

The City Council voted unanimously on Monday, October 5 to appoint Bonnie Tam as Piedmont's next Public Works Director. Tam brings nearly 20 years of local government experience in public works operations, capital improvement planning, and fiscal management. She most recently served as Public Works Director for the City of San Fernando and began her service with Piedmont on October 6.

"We are incredibly fortunate to have found someone with Bonnie's depth and breadth of experience," said Mayor Betsy Smegal Andersen. "She's led complex public works operations, managed major capital programs, and understands how to set priorities and make the most of limited resources. With so much important work underway throughout the city, Bonnie has the experi-

See Bonnie Tam on page 25



Piedmont's new Public Works Director Bonnie Tam



Sammy Fischer helped set up the Wildwood Dads Club Pumpkin Patch on opening weekend, the first delivery of pumpkins weighed 13,000 pounds.

Patch sales notch 1000 gourds for Wildwood

By Jay Russell

Pumpkin sales at the Wildwood Dads Club's (WWDC) Pumpkin Patch are scorching hot this year, with more than 1,100 pumpkins, gourds and other items sold in the first 10 days. A big reinforcement, sure to tip the scales, is en route as well; Giant Jack will arrive this week.

When the giant pumpkin arrives patch visitors can pay $1 to guess Giant Jack's weight. The closest guest will win possession and curbside delivery of the enormous gorgeous gourd for Halloween. Giant Jack will magically vanish from the winner's home in November, courtesy of the Fuji Melons delivery team.

Patch Papa Matt Derrigo and his seventh-grade daughter, Sara Derrigo, both returned to the Patch this year as WWDC and Wildwood alums. The duo helped create a new fall photo spot for visiting families to create lasting memories. After years of visiting the Patch as an elementary school student, Sara is now helping shape the traditions and experi-

See Pumpkin Patch on page 9

Candidates' Q & A – City Council Week 6

By Jake Lannon

Each election cycle, the *Piedmont Post* provides extensive coverage of each candidate to help residents make informed voting decisions.

For this year's race, the *Post* will send one question per week to the candidates running for City Council until Election Day. The five City Council candidates vying for three open seats received the question on Tuesday, September 27, and were asked to reply in 200 words.

Week 6 question:

The police and fire departments are highly regarded amongst the public. According to the fire department's union, they are asking for health benefits and retention pay to help recruitment and retention efforts. Would you, as a councilmember, support funding the union's requests? If so, how would you fund these increased benefits?

Bill Reichle
(ReichleforPiedmont.com)

Piedmont residents I speak with consistently place a high value on public safety. Ensuring the police and fire departments have the personnel, training, and equipment they need — when they need them — will always be my top priority.

That is why I support local Measure GG on November's ballot. Living in a high-cost metropolitan area with a competitive employment market creates inflationary pressure on the city budget, which limits management and personnel options. Measure GG is a well-thought-out solution to raise revenue that will stay here in Piedmont to fund essential services, including public safety.

See Candidates' Q&A on page 27

League of Women Voters hosts forum for City Council candidates

By Jake Lannon

The Piedmont League of Women Voters hosted a Candidates Forum on Tuesday, September 29. The hour-long forum asked candidates running for City Council to respond to many of the community's pressing questions. The five candidates running for three positions are Nancy Beninati, Adam Hundt, Tom Ramsey, Bill Reichle and Sunny Bostrom-Fleming.

For the first time in over six years, the LWVP hosted the forum in person for the community to attend. The forum was held in the City Council chambers of City Hall and was broadcast live through the league's YouTube channel and KCOM.

LWVP volunteers Jennifer Giessler and Kathleen Quenneville served as moderator and timekeeper. The forum allowed each candidate to provide a two-minute opening statement introducing themselves, their credentials, and why they're running for City Council.

After the opening statements,

See LWVP Forum on page 27

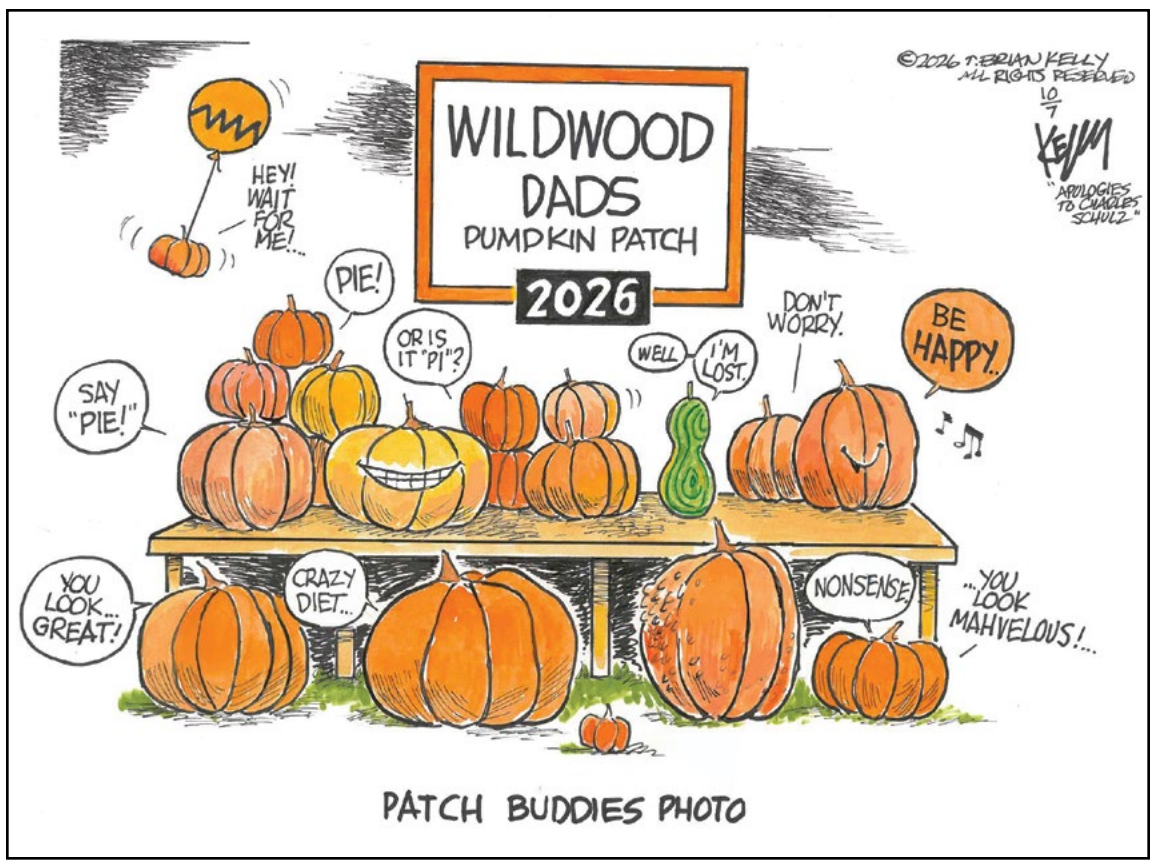


Candidates prepare their opening statements in the City Council chambers.

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PATCH BUDDIES PHOTO

Piedmont Post news rack at Mulberry's

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Missed *Piedmont Post* Delivery?

If your *Piedmont Post* was not delivered this week, you are welcome to pick up your copy from the *Piedmont Post* office at 3756 Grand Ave, Suite 203, Oakland Monday through Friday between 8 a.m. and 6 p.m.

Thank you for supporting your Piedmont Post.

Piedmont Post

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Collecting photos for Where in the World

For 28 years, Piedmont residents have made sure their travels are well documented, with photos of family members reading the *Piedmont Post* in far-off places throughout the world, and some nearby.

The *Post* invites families to send photos with the *Post* from near and far for publication in *Where in the World Are We* on the back page of the paper. With people able to travel once again, there is no better time to have your photo in the *Post.*

Send photos as .jpg files to: news@piedmont-post.com, and be sure to include a brief description of the location where the photo was taken.

READ IT IN THE *POST*

Quote of the Week

"Losing is not my enemy. Fear of losing is my enemy."

– Rafael Nadal
b. 1986
Spanish professional tennis champion

Opinion

City needs to fix hiring procedure at Fire Dept.

Editor:

We seek your assistance in making sure that Piedmont Firefighters are accorded salaries and health benefits in keeping with the fact that they are our Piedmont citizens' extended family in terms of their dedication to our health and safety.

We moved to Piedmont in 1993 and raised our two children here. We have experienced the intelligence, caring and decision-making of our Piedmont Firefighters. Had we not personally benefited from the firefighters' kindness and skill, we would still feel tremendous gratitude to them for being here just in case.

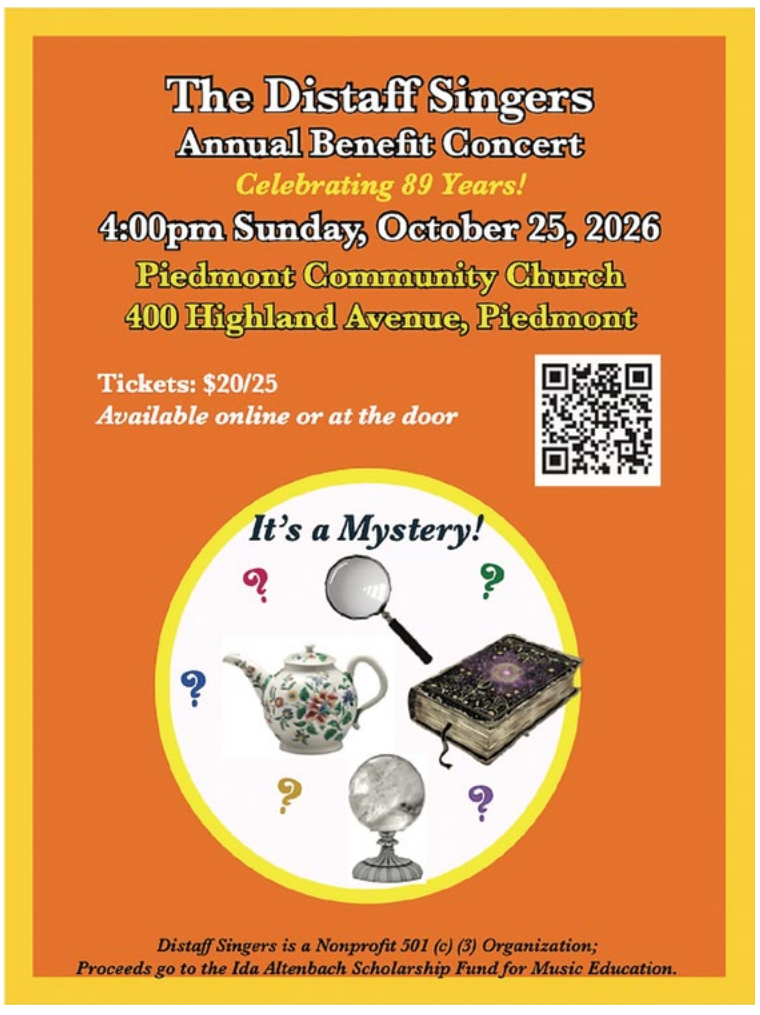
We were very distressed to read the article in the September 23 Piedmont Post indicating that negotiations between the firefighters and the city are at a standstill. We carefully read the firefighters' concerns about the necessity of 1) having pay increases to encourage longevity, and 2) having retirement benefits to cover firefighters' medical care for the period between retirement and Social Security eligibility. We share the firefighters' underlying concern about inadequate staffing which requires excessive overtime to keep us safe.

As residents and taxpayers, we support the firefighters' demands. Piedmont prides itself on being a city that is at the forefront of good decision-making. Piedmont needs to step up to support the firefighters and to inform its citizens what efforts and finances are required to do so. We rely on Piedmont Firefighters for our lives and the lives of our children. Is there anything more important? The firefighters' knowledge, skills, courage and work ethic should be celebrated and honored by accepting their demands.

We are both retired attorneys; Joe represented injured workers and clients denied social security disability; I practiced civil rights law. As residents of Piedmont, we find the city's response puzzling and extraordinarily short-sighted (using overtime instead of properly hiring, making the very hiring process discouraging by not providing the enticement of raises after certain years of service are reached, by not meeting the basic human need of health insurance until Social Security eligibility is reached).

We look forward to hearing from you.

–Susan Goldsmith and Joseph Waxman



How to get news in the *Post*

The *Piedmont Post* welcomes its readers to express their opinions on any topic. Columns in the *Piedmont Post* are exclusive and may not be reprinted without permission.

The *Post* reserves the right to edit any pieces or letters submitted. Opinion pieces should be limited to 400 words, letters to the editor to 200 words.

Photo submissions: Please submit photos at 6 inches in width and at a resolution of 200 dpi in jpeg format.

Do you have some news? Send your photos or stories to 3756 Grand Ave., #203, Oakland, CA 94610, or email them to news@piedmont-post.com. It's that easy. (Send us an attachment or cut and paste your text into the body of the email.)

The deadline for submitting news, photos and opinion items is Friday.

Letters to the Editor

Yes on Measure GG

Editor,

We are writing to Piedmont voters to urge a YES vote on Measure GG. Our families planted roots in Piedmont more than 100 years ago. We have made our home here because Piedmont offers a unique combination of small-town ambiance with strong public safety, outstanding public schools and excellent quality of life amenities such as beautiful parks, strong recreation programs and lovely public spaces.

We believe the financial experts who are telling us we soon will have a shortfall in revenues to pay for existing city services, facilities and infrastructure. The cuts that will come if that happens, most likely starting with "quality of life" expenses, threaten the things we hold most dear about Piedmont.

We believe the small increase in the real estate transfer tax proposed by Measure GG is the most painless method of dealing with the threat. It is only imposed at a time when property is being sold—a time when funds are most likely to be available to make a payment. Your YES vote on Measure GG will help preserve the Piedmont that has kept our families here for so long.

–Fran Bishopric Wolfe and Cameron Wolfe, Jr.

Support Measure GG: Support our community

Editor,

My family moved to Piedmont for the schools AND for the public safety. Having a local police and fire department won't protect everyone from all crimes and accidents, but knowing that our professional first responders have the ability to respond in 5 minutes or less is very reassuring.

These services are paid for by tax dollars which are allocated annually by our elected leaders, supported by volunteer financial experts, and professional city staff. The entire process is public and the proposed and approved budgets are posted on the City's web site at https://piedmont.ca.gov. The budget reflects our community's priorities of fiscal responsibility and public safety. This is reflected in the fact that the vast majority of operating expenditures go to the police, fire, and public works departments.

When people ask me what Measure GG will support, I tell them it will support what our community values. It will support all the things that make Piedmont a safe place to live and raise our families. Please join me in voting Yes on Measure GG.

–Kim Hunter
Retired Alameda County Senior Deputy District Attorney

Keep Piedmont moving forward with Measure GG

Dear Editor,

When I was young, Piedmont Recreation Department programs were instrumental in my development and helped form the person I am today. When I was fortunate enough to serve as Piedmont's Recreation Director and later as City Administrator, I gained insight into the ongoing cost of the many services provided by the City of Piedmont to the community. From streets to parks, sidewalks to police cars, fire apparatus to building maintenance, the costs to provide essential services to Piedmont have continued to rise.

Piedmont is one of a small number of California cities whose revenues are primarily property based. This funding structure severely limits options for increased revenues needed to keep Piedmont from falling further behind. Measure GG is a reasonable way to provide additional and ongoing funds to support city services, while not placing an ongoing burden on property owners. If approved, Measure GG will bring Piedmont's transfer tax more in line with our surrounding communities and provide approximately $1.5 million in additional revenue to support essential services and city infrastructure.

Piedmonters understand the value of ongoing investment, especially in community services and assets. Supporting Measure GG is a way to keep up and keep Piedmont moving forward for years to come.

Sincerely,
Sara Lillevand
Retired City Administrator

Join us in supporting Adam Hundt

Editor,

As Piedmont residents since 2012 and parents of two Piedmont Middle School students, we offer our enthusiastic support for Adam Hundt's candidacy for Piedmont City Council.

In a close-knit city like Piedmont, effective leadership requires a deep understanding of our community's values and priorities, along with a rigorous, forward-looking approach to our unique challenges. Adam embodies these qualities. He has a natural curiosity and is already hard at work listening to and learning from other residents and city leaders. His educational background in business, engineering, and public policy gives him sharp problem-solving skills and a collaborative style, while his professional experience in operations and supply chain management provides the analytical discipline needed to tackle Piedmont's long-term infrastructure challenges.

As a father of two young children, Adam has his finger on the pulse of the issues facing local families and demonstrates a genuine drive to ensure Piedmont remains a welcoming place for residents of all ages. His platform strikes the right balance for our city's future, placing emphasis on energy-efficient home upgrades, improved sustainability, and mitigating community risks from wildfires and other natural threats.

Adam will bring a fresh perspective, analytical approach, and creative problem-solving to Piedmont's city governance. We're excited to support his candidacy and encourage you to join us in voting for Adam Hundt for City Council.

Sincerely,
Erin and Andrew Schultz

Vote for Bill Reichle

Dear Piedmont Neighbors,

Ballots will arrive soon, and we have an opportunity to elect outstanding community members to our Piedmont City Council.

One of your three votes should be for Bill Reichle.

Bill has a deep appreciation for Piedmont. He has lived in Piedmont for 26 years; his wife and daughters went through the Piedmont schools. Bill served on the board of the Piedmont Education Foundation, Camp Augusta, and Piedmont Soccer Club.

Bill has a wealth of experience navigating complex situations. He worked as an administrator at UC Berkeley for 18 years, listening to stakeholders and finding solutions to longstanding issues.

Bill takes initiative and gets things done. Bill's priorities for City Council are public safety, fiscal discipline, and community engagement. We are so fortunate that Bill wants to devote his next chapter to serving Piedmont. Bill will work tirelessly to improve our beloved community.

In a town of smart people, it's

See Letters on page 25

VIEWPOINT

Reelect Dr. Cindi Reiss as Peralta Community College District Trustee, Area 5

Editor,

Having served eight years on the Piedmont City Council, including two years as mayor, I understand deeply that the true measure of public service is not the popularity of every individual decision; it is whether the institution is stronger, more accountable, and better prepared for the future when one's service concludes. That is why I am again supporting Dr. Cindi Reiss for the Peralta Community College District Board.

When I endorsed Cindi in 2022, I noted her educational and accreditation experience, devotion to the common good, attention to detail, intellect and vision. I also recognized her willingness to challenge entrenched interests in pursuit of sound fiscal management. When she ran for the Board in 2018, Peralta faced serious financial instability, accreditation concerns, leadership turnover, board conflict, board micromanagement of chancellors and possible state-takeover of the district. Cindi Reiss has fulfilled those promises.

Today, Peralta is financially and institutionally stronger. Its four colleges are fully accredited. Stable executive leadership, stronger financial practices, greater transparency, and more disciplined long-range planning have replaced years of instability. Recent credit ratings reflect increased confidence in the District's governance and financial direction, while a 2025 bond-refunding transaction saved taxpayers $13.7 million.

These gains did not happen by accident. Cindi helped foster a Board culture focused on its proper responsibilities: setting policy, safeguarding public resources, requiring accountability, and supporting strong professional leadership without micromanaging it. She has also demonstrated the courage to make difficult decisions when the district's long-term interests required them.

But recovery is not completion. Peralta must now carry its Transformation Plan from vision into implementation. That means reducing fragmentation, coordinating programs and services, strengthening pathways for students, and building a fiscal structure capable of sustaining the colleges well beyond the tenure of any trustee or administrator.

As Piedmont residents, we have a direct stake in Peralta's future, in its strength and success. Whether it's through our many Piedmont high school students that have participated in dual enrollment with Peralta by taking Calculus III: Partial Differentiation, Discrete Mathematics, Linear Algebra or business management classes; adults that have taken art and language classes, or through the thousands of students that Peralta's colleges serve in Alameda County, Piedmont benefits from a strong Peralta Community College system. When Peralta helps students earn degrees, certificates or transfer to universities, and build economically secure lives, the benefits extend well beyond its campuses.

A strong Peralta means a stronger regional workforce, greater economic mobility, responsible stewardship of taxpayer dollars, and a healthier and more stable East Bay. Our support of Peralta's colleges

is an investment in the regional institutions and quality of life on which Piedmont itself depends.

I urge my fellow Piedmonters to reelect Dr. Cindi Reiss as Peralta Community College District Trustee, Area 5, on November 3.

Best,
Teddy Gray King

YES on GG

to Support Piedmont's Essential Services

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Hundreds of your friends and neighbors and counting!

YESonGG.com

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Local Items

Community invited to Mayor Andersen's State of the City address on Oct. 15

Mayor Betsy Smegal Andersen will deliver Piedmont's 2026 State of the City address on Thursday, October 15, at 5:30 p.m. in Community Hall. The evening is a chance to come together as a community to celebrate Piedmont, reflect on recent accomplishments, learn about work underway now, and look at the challenges ahead.

Andersen's address will look across city government at the projects, priorities, and challenges shaping the city's work today. As she approaches the end of her term after nine years on the City Council, she'll also reflect on how her perspective has changed after seeing firsthand what it takes to deliver the services, projects, and programs residents rely on.

"After nine years on the City Council, I have a deep appreciation for what it takes to make this city work," said Mayor Andersen. "We have much to celebrate, but we also have real challenges in front of us. I hope people will come spend the evening with us and leave with a stronger sense of where Piedmont stands today."

Come to hear what's happening – and stay for the conversation. For residents who want to understand what the city is working on and where Piedmont is headed, the event offers a chance to hear directly from the Mayor and get a broader view of the work happening across the city.

A reception with light refreshments will follow the address, with an opportunity to connect with Councilmembers, city staff, and neighbors. Community members planning to attend are encouraged to RSVP at piedmont.ca.gov/SOTC-RSVP. All are welcome, and sharing with your networks is appreciated!

Voting information for the November 3 Election

On November 3, Piedmont voters will elect representatives to fill three seats on the Piedmont City Council and to federal, state, county, and special district offices. The ballot also includes a proposed increase to the City's Real Estate Transfer Tax and 14 statewide ballot measures.

All registered Alameda County voters will receive a vote-by-mail ballot. The Registrar of Voters began mailing voter information guides on September 24 and will begin mailing ballots starting Monday, October 5. Sign up for the Registrar of Voters' Track My Ballot tool to get notified when your ballot is mailed, received, and counted.

The last day to register to vote for the November 3 election is Monday, October 19. If you're already registered, check your registration status before October 19 to confirm that your information is correct. You'll need to re-register if you have moved, changed your name, or wish to change your political party preference. Voter registration forms are available at the City Clerk's Office and from the Registrar of Voters. You can also register to vote online at registertovote.ca.gov.

In Piedmont, ballot drop boxes are near the mailboxes at Highland Way and Mountain Avenue and are available 24 hours a day. The Alameda County Sheriff's Office picks up ballots from the drop boxes and returns them to the Registrar of Voters daily. The last pickup will be at 8 p.m. on Tuesday, November 3.

The Registrar of Voters is hosting a series of pop-up events throughout Alameda County where voters can hand their ballot directly to ROV staff. More information on the location of the pop-up events can be found online at: https://acvote.alamedacountyca.gov/dropstop.

If you mail your ballot through the post office, it must be postmarked by November 3 and received by November 10. Whether submitting your ballot by mail or a secure drop box, remember to sign the back of your return envelope – otherwise your vote will not be counted!

Alameda County voters can vote in person at any of 100 Vote Centers across the county. In Piedmont, the Veterans Memorial Building at 401 Highland Avenue will serve as a Vote Center. All vote centers will be open:

- Saturday, October 31 – Monday, November 2: 9 a.m. - 5 p.m.
- Tuesday, November 3: 7 a.m. - 8 p.m.

A smaller subset of vote centers will be open 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. for 11 days before the election, starting on October 24. The closest 11-day vote center to Piedmont is in Oakland at Parks Chapel AME Church, 476 34th Street.

If you have any questions regarding your voter registration, ballot status, or voting locations, contact the Alameda County Registrar of Voters at (510) 272-6933.

City Council awards $785,000 contract for Moraga Avenue Pedestrian Safety Project

By Jake Lannon

At the September 22 City Council meeting, the Council voted to award the Moraga Avenue Pedestrian Safety Project contract to Terocons Inc. for $785,533. The project will install safety improvements as recommended in the Piedmont Safer Streets Plan. Construction is expected to begin in early October along Moraga Avenue between Ramona Avenue and Red Rock Avenue.

The project will install bulb-outs and high-visibility crosswalk striping at the intersection of Ramona and Moraga. The intersection of Monticello & Moraga will receive a landscaped pedestrian refuge island and high-visibility crosswalk striping. The last intersection, Mesa & Moraga, will receive a bulb-out, flashing beacons, and a repositioned crosswalk for improved visibility.

Interim Public Works Director Rich Cunningham presented the project to the City Council, detailing some of the changes the project will make.

"The intersection between Moraga and Monticello, which you have to walk 120 feet across that intersection to cross it, was not safe, and so we've put a traffic island there. Part of that traffic island is set aside for landscape, and we're bringing water across the street from the cemetery planted area via a pipe that will be installed before paving the Moraga Avenue section. The design also includes preservation of the bike lane," said Cunningham.

The city will fund the project through an Alameda County Transportation Commission (ACTC) grant, which awarded the city $748,000 for design and construction. The ACTC funds transportation improvements throughout Alameda County that facilitate safe, efficient, and accessible travel for all types of transportation.

The City's 2021 Safer Streets Plan identified the Mesa/Moraga intersection as the highest-priority location for citywide pedestrian safety enhancements, prioritizing intersections based on proximity to a school, location on an arterial street, and inclusion on a bike/bus route. Moraga Avenue is one of the few arterial roadways within the City of Piedmont eligible for regional transportation funding.

"There's been almost uniform support across the community. We got a lot of nice emails, proactive people up and down Moraga who are all for it," said Cunningham.

The contract agreement with Terocons Inc. is for 16 weeks to complete the work.

READ IT IN THE *POST*

Fire Dept. seeks community input on disaster preparedness

The Piedmont Fire Department is asking community members to complete a brief disaster preparedness survey by October 30. The survey will measure changes since 2024 and help guide future preparedness efforts.

Preparedness knowledge and actions have changed since the city's first community survey in 2024. This survey will help the city understand how prepared the community is for earthquakes, wildfires, and other disasters.

The survey should take about 5-7 minutes to complete and is available at piedmont.ca.gov/DisasterSurvey. The city's 2024 survey showed that many respondents recognized disaster risk but had not taken some basic preparedness steps.

Among respondents:

- 73% were registered for AC Alert
- 22% had a current household emergency communication plan
- 34% had a current two-week emergency water supply
- 27% felt confident or very confident in their knowledge of how to prepare for disasters

This year's survey revisits many of these measures and includes new questions about how the city's preparedness efforts have developed. This includes earthquake safety and steps that residents can take to minimize wildfire risks at home.

The survey will ask where people turn for information during an emergency, what gets in the way of becoming better prepared, and what kinds of resources would be most useful.

Since the 2024 survey, Piedmont Fire has expanded preparedness outreach and community engagement, including:

- Updating Piedmont's Local Hazard Mitigation Plan with extensive community participation
- Increasing education about wildfire home hardening and defensible space, including a series of presentations to community groups
- Conducting a practical wildfire evacuation exercise in the Blair/Scenic/Alta neighborhood and creating an at-home evacuation exercise available to all households
- Continuing year-round outreach on emergency alerts, evacuation readiness, and household preparedness

The survey data will help the city evaluate where the work is having an impact and what gaps remain. It will also establish a stronger baseline for earthquake preparedness as Piedmont Fire looks to expand outreach in this area.

Results will help guide future communications, educational resources, exercises, and community programs. Complete the survey by October 30 at piedmont.ca.gov/DisasterSurvey. For resources and information about preparing for disasters, visit piedmont.ca.gov/Disaster.



ADVERTISE IN THE *POST*

Barbara Lee announces $5,000,000 in state funding for Fairyland

By Jay Russell

On Monday, October 5, Oakland Mayor Barbara Lee announced that Children's Fairyland has secured a $5,000,000 allocation from the state of California to close out phase one of its capital investment in the park. The funds are designed to facilitate the initial stages of restoration and revitalization.

"It's really a storybook that comes to life. Regardless of how old you are or young you are, my family can attest to the fact, this is a dream come true," said Lee.

Children's Fairyland CEO Kymberly Miller elucidated the details of the funding, $3,000,000 will be designated to the park's capital investment to make "sure we are taking care of this physical space for 76 more years."

The remaining two million will go to the park's general operations. The funds come from the state's budget which has allocated $14 million for Oakland community organizations, small businesses, public safety, and transitional housing.

Other Oakland institutions receiving state funding include: Juntos Fruitvale Cultural Arts Center, Samuel Merritt University's human trafficking prevention initiative, commercial corridors across Oakland, the city's Department of Violence Prevention and The Holland transitional housing facility.

"For 76 years, Fairyland has given Oakland's children a place to imagine what's possible. I still remember bringing my sons here, and today we're making sure the next generation gets that same magic. This $5 million is a proud victory for Oakland because every dollar we put into community spaces comes back to us in the children they raise," said Lee.

Children's Fairyland has been a vital part of Oakland's culture since opening in 1950. As the park that pioneered children's entertainment in this country, Fairyland forever changed the landscape of "family fun" as it is known today. Children's Fairyland is ten acres of green space on the shores of Lake Merritt, designed for outdoor play and low-tech, high-touch hands-on learning. It is a rare and increasingly precious resource for children.

The $5 million allocation will fund numerous initiatives within Fairyland's strategic capital

investment plan, including essential infrastructure and facility upgrades. Miller describes the funding as foundational, rather than final.

"This funding is a launchpad, not a landing place. We have much more work to do to create the Fairyland of tomorrow. We're deeply grateful to Governor Newsom, Mayor Lee, and our State of California partners for recognizing what Fairyland means to this community, to Oakland, and to the entire Bay Area. We are laying the groundwork for Fairyland's financial sustainability so we can continue to be a safe and inclusive environment for playing and learning, where children build critical literacy skills and grow both socially and emotionally," said Miller.



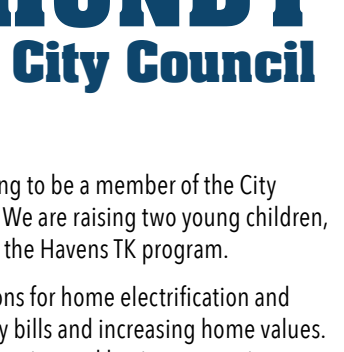
Oakland Mayor Barbara Lee (left) and Fairyland CEO Kymberly Miller announced the state has granted Children's Fairyland $5,000,000 from the 2026-27 state budget.

The state funding is a commitment to ensure the 76-year-old iconic and beloved Oakland destination remains a safe, vibrant, and accessible oasis for generations to come. It also signals a broader shift underway at Fairyland. As an organization upheld and supported by its community, admissions, memberships, and the generosity of donors of all kinds, Children's Fairyland is now adding the kind of institutional support it needs to fuel the next phase of its modernization.

Learn more at Fairyland.org.

Adoptable Cat of the Week

By Quinn White



Adopt Mocha through Cat Town.

Mocha is a 6-year-old Siamese mix who knows how to make herself at home. Although she's guarded in new situations, when she's relaxed, you might find her snoozing in a lap or accepting belly rubs. When she wants to play, you'll love watching her pounce after her favorite wand toys, zoom through her tunnel, and tackle her tiny toy caterpillar.

That playful streak can occasionally get ahead of her manners: Mocha can switch quickly from cuddling to play mode, and may grab or swat at nearby hands. So she'll do well with an adopter who has enough experience with cats to notice when to preemptively redirect her energy. She prefers to be the only cat in her kingdom, and takes daily anxiety medication to help her feel her best.

Give her the boundaries she craves, and the playtime she adores, and you'll have a clever, affectionate companion who greets you at the door with little meows, rubs against your legs, and sleeps on your chest. Her foster sums her up simply: "She's such a beautiful, sweet girl."

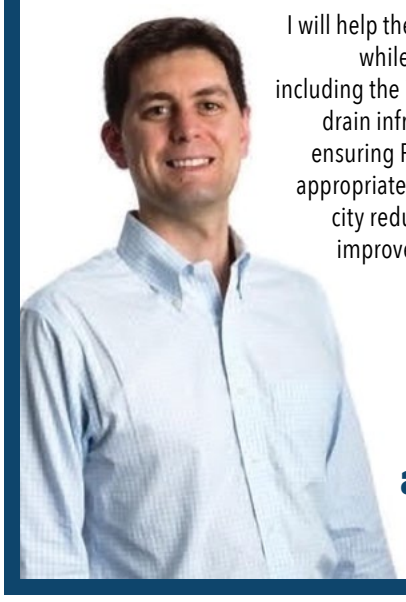
Mocha is spayed, vaccinated, microchipped, and FeLV/FIV negative. Learn more at www.cattownoakland.org or email adopt@cattownoakland.org to ask about meeting her!

ADAM HUNDT
for Piedmont City Council

Dear Piedmont residents:

My name is Adam Hundt. I am running to be a member of the City Council. My wife is a proud Cal Bear. We are raising two young children, ages 2 and 4. Our 4-year-old attends the Havens TK program.

If elected, I will seek affordable options for home electrification and energy efficiency, lowering electricity bills and increasing home values. I can also use my two decades of education and business experience to find ways to attract small businesses into our town to provide family-friendly services such as a café or ice cream shop.



I will help the city maintain its beautiful parks while addressing infrastructure needs including the improvement of sewer and storm drain infrastructure. I will prioritize safety, ensuring Police and Fire Departments have appropriate facilities and equipment and the city reduces speeding, repairs roads, and improves pedestrian and bike pathways.

For more information, go to my website AdamHundt.com.

Sincerely,
Adam Hundt

adamhundt.com

Paid for by Adam Hundt for Piedmont City Council 2026, FPPC # 1496695

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Schools

PHS holds annual Consent Assembly

By Julia Stokes

On Wednesday, September 30, Piedmont High School held its annual Consent Assembly for seniors and freshmen. The assembly, organized by acting teacher Kim Taylor, junior Stella Joseph, and senior Ben Ramakrishnan, involved current PHS students reading real stories from anonymous PHS graduates about their experiences involving sexual assault and consent.

"The purpose of the Consent Assembly is to bring awareness and educate people about how to stay safe and how to prevent these stories from happening again," junior Ida Marshall said.

Marshall was one of 16 students who read stories. Although Marshall is enrolled in acting, students do not need to take acting to present in the assembly. A goal of the assembly is for people from across the school to be involved.

"I think it went well. All of the other story readers were really talented and I thought we made the stories sound really real. I heard stories about people being affected by it," Marshall said.

PHS also has a lunch club, Piedmont for Consent (P4C), that focuses on spreading awareness about consent. According to P4C co-president junior Sophia Puckett, the club's goal is to make sure everyone feels comfortable about consent and their personal boundaries.

Puckett said that club events this year include giving presentations about what consent is at elementary schools in Piedmont, along with partnering with an elective class at Piedmont Middle School.

"The middle school has a new class that's going to help us lead presentations for the elementary school. It's called LEAD," Puckett said. "It's an elective class, and it focuses on consent next semester."

P4C co-president junior Lucy Shoop said that they are working on a middle school assembly as well.

"We're working on a script that the middle schoolers are going to use in the new elective. Basically, we're going to help them teach," Shoop said.

The Consent Assembly happened to coincide with the reopening of a 2024 sexual assault case at Cornell University, which sparked conversations across the PHS campus. Puckett said that Piedmont for Consent held an open conversation at lunch for students to share their thoughts about the case.

"I think with the Cornell case, a lot of the stories and conversations can be triggering for a lot of people, and we want to make sure people have a place they can come if they need something," Puckett said.

Although Piedmont for Consent is not directly affiliated with the Consent Assembly, Puckett said that their goals very much align.

"The assembly is a great way that we are getting the message of consent culture out to Piedmont and other Bay Area schools," said Puckett.

The Consent Assembly takes place once a year, and Marshall said she hopes to continue her involvement.

"I really enjoyed doing it. I thought it was a really meaningful and valuable experience, and I hope I'm able to do it next year," Marshall said. "I think bringing awareness to this stuff is not talked about enough and that's why it's really important."

Julia Stokes is a junior at Piedmont High School and a student writer intern for the Piedmont Post.

Thinking Outside the Classroom

The season of the spider

By Dr. Megan Taylor

There are lots of signs that fall is arriving in the Bay Area. The days are getting shorter. Leaves are beginning to change. And in my family, we start looking for spiders.

Every year around this time, my kids and I search Golden Gate Park for shamrock orbweavers. They're hard to miss once you know what you're looking for: often in wait for prey at the center of giant, wheel-shaped webs— where their family name "orbweaver" comes from—these spiders' large abdomens range in color from pale cream to bright orange, and their long legs are striped with light and dark colors. It's no wonder local birds often notice them before we do!

I know for some of you, I've already lost you.

Spiders make plenty of people uncomfortable. But I've always loved them, and over the years my kids and I have made a tradition of getting closer rather than backing away. We find a few orbweavers each fall in the park and think of them as our "pets" for the season, returning regularly to watch them spin webs, grow, and change.

By the time we encounter these adult orbweavers at their biggest and most spectacular, they're nearing the end of their lives. They've reproduced and left behind egg sacs containing the beginnings of another generation. And eventually, the spiders we've been watching disappear.

There is something both beautiful and sad about witnessing the cycle.



Photo by Megan Taylor for the Exploratorium

Megan Taylor's twin daughters take a closer look at shamrock orbweavers and their webs in Golden Gate Park.

The natural world gives us countless opportunities to notice cycles of change. Flowers bloom and die. Leaves fall and return. Insects emerge and disappear. A spider reaches the end of its life, but leaves behind hundreds of eggs that will begin the cycle again.

This fall, I encourage you to look for opportunities to notice life changing around you, including the parts that may feel strange, uncomfortable, or even a little scary. Ask questions. Look closer. Come back tomorrow.

You might be surprised by what captures your curiosity.

See TOTC on page 9

Piedmont Branch Library News

Chair Yoga

Thursday, October 8 — 10:30 – 11:30 a.m.

Chair yoga is designed for those who have difficulty getting up and down from the floor due to arthritis, knee injury, back pain or any other reason.

Learn from a certified yoga instructor how a daily practice will improve your strength, flexibility, and balance. Meditation elements are included to help you develop greater body awareness and to help you set your intention before the class.

Taught by local instructor Bett Bollhoefer, who is certified in Radiant Body Yoga.

Coffee with a Cop

Saturday, October 10 — 11:00 a.m. – 12:00 p.m.

Join your neighbors and public servants for coffee & conversation! No agenda or speeches—just a chance to ask questions, voice concerns, and get to know the beat officers in your neighborhood.

Featuring complimentary café-style beverages from Goldfish Coffee Company's mobile barista cart, including hot and iced espresso drinks, tea lattes (including matcha, hojicha, and London Fog), hot chocolate, lemonade, flavored steamers, and your choice of dairy or plant-based milk.

All are welcome!

Knitting & Crochet Circle with Susan Segal!

Monday, October 12 — 11:00 a.m. – 1:00 p.m.

Join us every second and fourth Monday of the month for a delightful early afternoon of yarn, needles, and good company at our Adult Knitting & Crochet Circle!

Settle into a warm and inviting space where creativity and conversation intertwine.

If you need assistance with anything or have questions, Susan is here to help. Join us and make the most of your knitting/crochet experience with us!

What to Bring:

- Your current knitting or crochet project
- Your preferred yarn and needles/hooks
- A smile and a willingness to connect with fellow crafters

Whether you're a seasoned pro or just starting, everyone is welcome!

While we'd love to accommodate everyone, keep in mind that space availability will be on a first-come, first-served basis.

Toddler Storytime

Tuesday, October 13 — 10:15 – 10:30 a.m.

Songs, active rhymes and stories especially for ages 18 months to 3 years. Every Tuesday morning at 10:15 a.m.

Stay and play after Storytime with fun age-appropriate toys through 11:15 a.m. If conditions allow, Storytime will be held outside the library building.

We ask that patrons refrain from wearing scented products.

Teen Pop Up Crafts

Tuesday, October 13 — 3:30 – 4:30 p.m.

Teens! Come and hang out and get creative with us every 2nd and 4th Tuesday of the month.

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Valerie Lee & Robbin H. Lee, PHS alums

Dress Best for Less grants $100,000 to Piedmont schools

By Heather Meil

Dress Best for Less, Piedmont's longtime resale shop, has pledged $100,000 to the Piedmont Education Foundation's 2026 Giving Campaign, continuing a relationship with Piedmont schools that has spanned more than four decades.

"Dress Best for Less is thrilled to kick off the start of the 2026 Giving Campaign with our $100,000 pledge," said DBFL President Nagisa Yamamoto. "Our long relationship with PEF has continued to be strong, and we are honored to support the #1 unified school district in Northern California."

Founded in 1982, Dress Best for Less has contributed more than $1 million to Piedmont schools and neighboring communities over the past 44 years. The organization's annual support of PEF has become a longstanding tradition and reflects its broader commitment to the Piedmont community.

"We are incredibly grateful for this generous contribution and for DBFL's longstanding commitment to our schools," said PEF Executive Director Heather Frank. "Their continued support helps provide the teachers, staff and programs that make a difference for Piedmont students every day."

The $100,000 pledge comes as PEF launches its 2026 Giving Campaign, which raises funds to help bridge the gap between public funding and the cost of providing Piedmont students with the educational experience the community expects.



PEF Executive Director Heather Frank accepts a $100,000 Giving Campaign pledge from Dress Best for Less President Nagisa Yamamoto at DBFL's store on Piedmont Avenue.

The community can also celebrate with Dress Best for Less on Friday, October 16, when the shop sponsors the Piedmont Recreation Department's Movie in the Park, featuring a showing of Wonka. DBFL will have a selection of Halloween costumes available for families who are still searching for the perfect costume.

Located on Piedmont Avenue next to Piedmont Grocery, Dress Best for Less sells affordable vintage and gently used clothing, accessories and home décor. The resale shop also promotes sustainability by giving pre-loved items a second life and keeping usable goods out of the landfill.

To learn more, visit dressbestforless.org. To make a donation to this year's Giving Campaign, visit PiedmontEdFoundation.org/donate.

To take or not to take: that is the PSAT and preACT question

By Ayla Blanford

After years of colleges moving away from requiring standardized testing, the admissions process is shifting once again. As more universities reinstate SAT or ACT requirements, high school students are reconsidering the role tests, like the PSAT, play in their college preparation.

During COVID-19, many universities stopped requiring test scores as part of their application process, shifting to test-optional or test-blind. As testing gains popularity, many students view the PSAT as their first step of the college application process.

"I took the PSAT to get a baseline of what my score was without studying, so that I could compare it to my preACT score to see which one I was better at," junior Chiara Silvio said.

Students often take these exams in their sophomore year of high school, so they can know which test they want to take and are most confident in junior year.

"I wanted to see which one I was better at so junior year I can really focus on studying," sophomore Naomi Jerez said.

Although the PSAT has become increasingly popular, some students are choosing to use other resources to determine which direction they want to go in.

"I did not take the PSAT; I didn't sign up for it because I plan to take the online ones at home," junior Kyla Williams said. "I was also going to take the SAT in December, January, and another one in March."

As top schools switch to being test-required, it affects students differently depending on their educational experiences and future goals.

"A lot of people study for it, and it's not actually accurate, it's more about the tools you have available to you than how well you'd naturally do," Silvio said.

While preparation plays a large role in a student's success when taking a standardized test, each student nationwide is taking the same test. This uniformity provides colleges with a baseline to help determine a student's admission.

"Giving your grades or just your transcript only shows in comparison to your school," Williams said. "For the SAT, it's an overall evaluation that doesn't solely compare to your surroundings."

With the increase in resources available to students, standardized tests help colleges determine how a student truly performs.

"Nowadays you can get good grades by taking online classes, and get into a good school," Jerez said. "With a standardized test, everyone's taking the same thing, so it's easier to compare scores objectively."

Taking the PSAT and preACT is not a required step for the real SAT or ACT, and can take multiple hours depending on testing location. PreACT exams were conducted in the PHS STEAM building on Saturday, October 3, starting at 8:45 a.m. and lasting for two hours and 45 minutes.

"The test was really draining, and it was a lot harder than I thought it was going to be," Silvio said.

However, many students say the benefits outweigh the effort required.

"I'll be able to know which format I like better and I'll also get an idea of the test taking environment," Jerez said.

Along with prepping students for the SAT, taking the PSAT offers students a series of other benefits to support their college applications.

"You can sign up for National Merit, because it helps you qualify if you take the PSAT," Williams said.

For the class of 2026, many universities have announced their switch from test optional to test required. Cornell University, Yale University, Columbia University and Princeton University are some of many that have announced their change. Many schools have also announced changes to their requirements that won't take effect for a few more years. The University of California schools (UC Berkeley, UCSB, UCLA, etc.) are still test-free for the fall 2027 admission, and are reviewing whether or not to bring back testing for future applicants, according to the University of California.

Ayla Blanford is a junior at Piedmont High School and a student writer intern with the Piedmont Post.

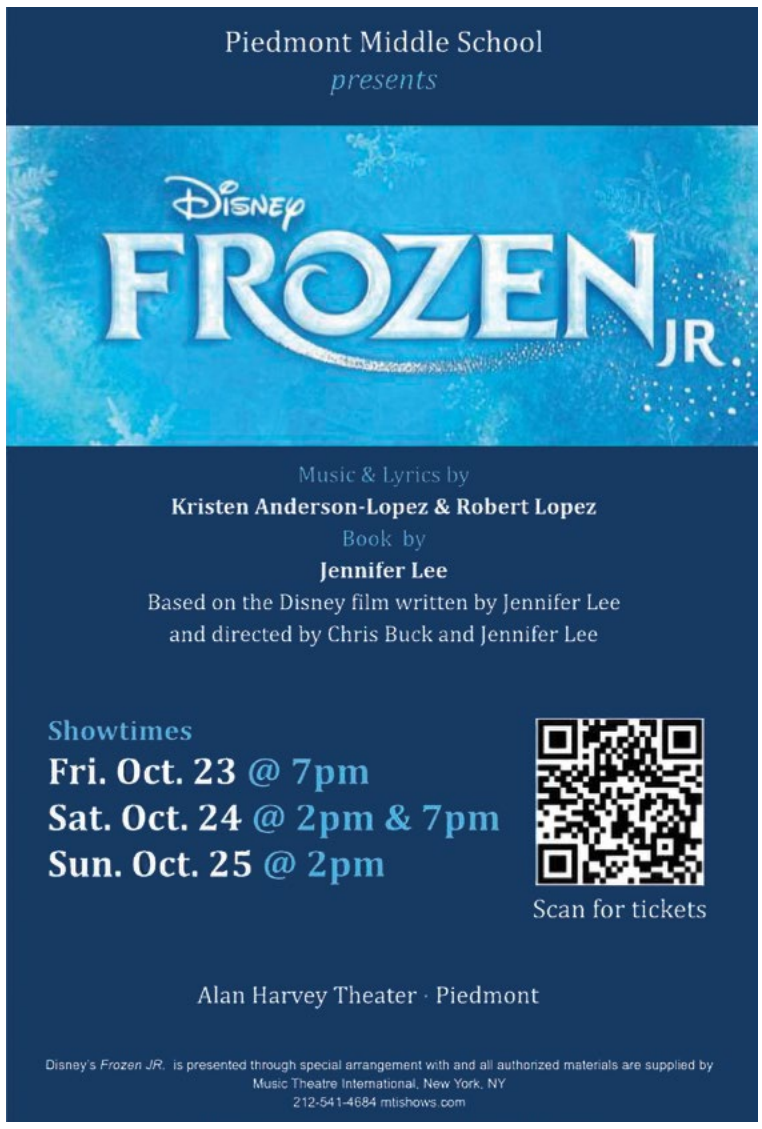
PMS musical *Frozen JR.* coming October 23-25

By Amy Moorhead

Piedmont Middle School presents *Frozen JR.* October 23-25, based on the 2018 Broadway musical. The show features all of the memorable songs from the animated film, with music and lyrics by Kristen Anderson-Lopez and Robert Lopez, plus five new songs written for the Broadway production.

A story of true love and acceptance between sisters, F*rozen JR.* expands upon the emotional relationship and journey between Princesses Anna and Elsa. When faced with danger, the two discover their hidden potential and the powerful bond of sisterhood. With a cast of beloved characters and loaded with magic, adventure, and plenty of humor, *Frozen JR.* is sure to thaw even the coldest heart.

Frozen JR. runs approximately 75 minutes, which includes intermission, and is appropriate for the entire family. Performances are Friday October 23, 7:00 p.m., Saturday, October 24, 2:00 p.m. & 7:00 p.m., and Sunday, October 25, 2:00 p.m. All performances are at the Alan Harvey Theater. Tickets are available for purchase online at https://phsmusicalsdance.ludus.com/index.php





Bringing Harvest Festival scarecrows to life

By Jay Russell

Every year, Harvest Festival scarecrows are constructed by Piedmont students to be auctioned off in Piedmont Park during the event to fund the schools. The Havens TK pumpkin and 3rd-grade turkey scarecrows both started as giant balloons coated with several layers of *Piedmont Post* paper strips and wood glue before coming to life at the festival.

Normally, each grade at the three elementary school makes its own scarecrow, but this year some grades combined forces and others did not participate. Those that were on display were fantastic. The Havens creators of two of the seven scarecrows shared their process with the *Post*.

"Due to drying time, we could only apply a couple of layers per day, working over several weekends alongside some late-night prep work. My kids, Simone and Sloane, did a lot of the initial papier-mâché work before our scheduled class work parties," said parent Holen Brady.



Havens students and parents build their Harvest Festival scarecrows from the inside out, with a giant balloon covered with strips of the *Piedmont Post*.



Cora, Isa, Poppy, and Sloane paint the Havens TK pumpkin scarecrow.



Havens TK and 3rd-graders



Sloane (left) and Simone with the finished Havens 3rd-grade turkey scarecrow named "Turk Turk."



Simone (left) and Sloane with the Havens TK pumpkin scarecrow on display at the Harvest Festival..

Brady shared that the main challenge was applying enough coats to dry thoroughly before the balloon lost air. One scarecrow had to be scrapped when a balloon deflated and distorted the shape. These two Havens scarecrows required three separate work parties, with 20 families in total participating.

"The kids really enjoyed the papier-mâché and painting, but the highlight for them is seeing their final product displayed at the Harvest Festival and knowing they helped create it," added Brady.

These scarecrows are not heavy, but their size makes transporting them tricky. The Fedor and Moravy Havens families put on their trucker hats and transported the giant turkey and pumpkin scarecrows to the park and then to the auction winners' homes.

This labor of love supports the schools while championing the arts, and the efforts of all scarecrow makers kept a beautiful Piedmont tradition alive.

FUN4KIDS
Event Calendar

By Jay Russell

Oakland Zoo
Oaklandzoo.org
9777 Golf Links Rd, Oakland; 632-9525

The Oakland Zoo sets the standard for world-class animal care in captivity. Guests will marvel at the many species taking up residence at the zoo, while learning about conservation in the wild. The zoo is open every day from 9:30 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. Take the gondola to the amazing boardwalk of the California Trail, for viewings of wolves, buffalo and bears. Amusement rides, including a brand-new electric train, are open as well. Make sure to buy tickets in advance for timed entry.

Adventure Playground
Berkeleyca.gov
160 University Avenue, Berkeley; 981-6720

This unique playground will have kids entertained and engrossed in outdoor play for hours. The space is open Saturday and Sunday, 11:00 a.m.–5:00 p.m. The playground features kid-designed and built forts, boats, and towers. Children under the age of 18 must have a supervising adult registered to attend and watch them during their time at the playground because this park lets kids create with hammers, saws, paint, and recycled materials.

Chabot Space & Science Center
Chabotspace.org
10000 Skyline Boulevard, Oakland; 336-7300

Chabot is now open Wednesday-Sunday, 10:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m., for a full day of fun and exploring the out-of-this-world exhibits. Older kids will love the shows in the planetarium and MegaDome, the boldest way to experience space and science, on the biggest of big screens. Every Friday and Saturday night the Chabot Observatory Deck has a free telescope viewing 7:30 to 10:30 p.m., as well, weather permitting, check their website for visibility status. Cleardarksky.com/c/ChbtSPCCAkey.html?1

Leona Canyon Hiking Trail
Ebparks.org/parks/leona
Campus Drive off Keller Avenue, Oakland, CA

This East Bay Regional Park, just seven miles from Piedmont, is a hidden outdoor hiking gem. The pristine wooded canyon is protected in this 290-acre parkland near Merritt College in Oakland. It is a great place for hiking, running, dog walking and biking. Get outside of the house for a taste of fresh autumn air.

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Pumpkin Patch

Continued from page 1



WWDC veteran Matt Derrigo and his daughter Sara Derrigo created this photo shoot backdrop for families visiting the Patch.

ences for the next generation of Piedmont kids.

Opening weekend and the first full week of sales have substantially outpaced recent years, and this past Sunday brought in more than double the sales of the comparable Sunday last year.

"That growth is especially notable because Patch pricing has stayed largely the same for the past four years, so the increase is coming from more visitors rather than higher prices," said Patch Papa Brian Fischer.

The high turnout is all the more impressive given this past weekend's heat wave; temperatures in the 90s didn't turn families away or smiles from patch visitors upside-down.

As of October 4, the Patch has sold 1,187 total items including 394 decorative pumpkins and gourds. Keeping the Patch open seven days a week, for five weeks requires 156 volunteer shifts and 90 Wildwood parents volunteers have already signed up to make the club's biggest fundraiser of the year possible.

WWDC Pumpkin Patch
Coaches Field
898 Red Rock Road
Mon-Fri: 4:00-6:00 p.m.
Sat-Sun: 10:00 a.m.-6:00 p.m.



Last year's Giant Jack weighed more than 100 stones, and for scale is pictured next to Alan, a four-month-old, in 2025. The 2026 Jack will arrive this week.

TOTC

Continued from page 6

If spiders still feel like too much of a stretch, perhaps monarch butterflies are more your speed. On October 24, join us for *We All Journey* (https://www.exploratorium.edu/visit/calendar/we-all-journey), a special daytime event at the Exploratorium exploring another remarkable cycle of life: the monarch's transformation from caterpillar to butterfly and its annual migration to Mexico, where its arrival often coincides with Día de Muertos. Through art and hands-on activities, families can explore how cultures find meaning in the natural cycles of life, change, and renewal.

Whether it's a spider or a butterfly, there's a lot to learn when we take the time to look closely.

Dr. Megan Taylor leads a team of educators, teacher educators, and scientists as Chief Teaching & Learning Officer at the Exploratorium. An enthusiastic Exploratorium visitor for over four decades, Dr. Taylor champions the power of hands-on discovery: that real learning lives not in what we're told, but in what we touch, question, and experience for ourselves—in classrooms, communities, and the curious moments of daily life.

Girl Scout Troop donates 800 books

On Saturday, September 26, Girl Scout Troop 32605 gathered books for their book drive. More than 800 books were donated by the troop to Bananas, a local nonprofit in Oakland that serves low-income families.

The troop of 12 Girl Scouts advertised for over a month about collecting lightly used books for kids age 0 to 8. The troop's collection of 800 books from Piedmont and Oakland residents surpassed the amount they collected last year by 200 books.

Completing the book drive helped the troop earn their Literacy Badge. Troop 32605 is a co-op troop led by parents Katy Bradford and Lauren Freeman this year. The troop puts its focus on community outreach and volunteerism, and different parents lead the monthly events.

The troop's next community service project will collect warm clothes to give to the homeless this winter.



Photos by Katy Bradford

Girl Scout Troop 32605 conducted a book drive last month. Front row: Ava W. (left), Lauren V., and Elora S. Back row: Jordan S. (left), Hana F., Kavya M., and June F.



Troop 32605 Girl Scout Lauren V. inspects one of the donated books.



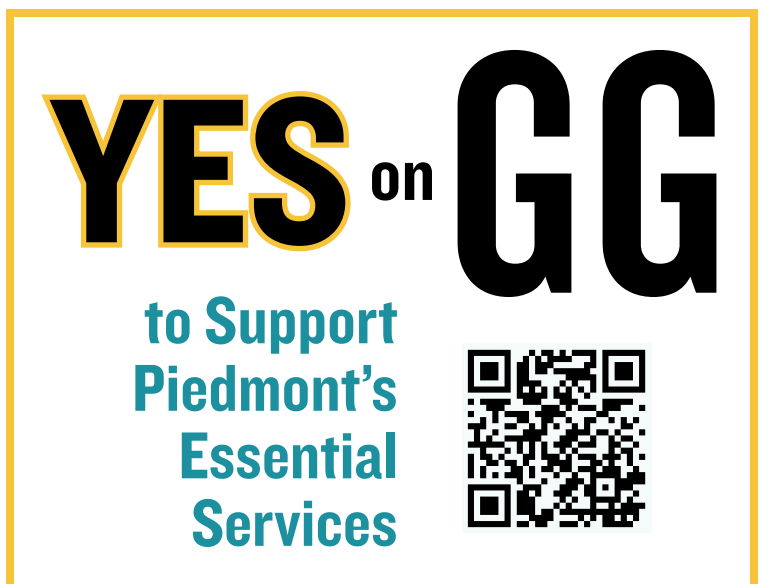
No scouting book drive is complete without s'mores constructed into hardcover books.



Girl Scouts and parents collected and then delivered hundred of pounds of books to the Oakland nonprofit Bananas.







STREET SWEEPING SCHEDULE – 2026-27

Street sweeping is critical for keeping storm drains clear during leaf drop season. Residents should move cars and any other obstacles blocking access to the curb off the street on street sweeping days.

October 5 - 16

Mon.	Tues.	Wed.	Thur.	Fri.
October 5	6	7	8	9
1-Odd	**2-O**	**3-O**	**4-O**	**5-O**
October 12	13	14	15	16
1-Even	**2-E**	**3-E**	**4-E**	**5-E**

E = Even Street Numbers O = Odd Street Numbers

Streets, by Zones — **Indicates streets where both even and odd addresses are swept on "even" days*

ZONE 1
Ashmount Ave
Cambrian Ave
Cavanagh Ct *
Crest Rd
Crocker Ave
(South of La Salle Ave)
Croydon Circle *
Estates Dr
Florada Ave
Glen Alpine Rd
Hampton Rd
(East of Sea View Ave)
Huntleigh Rd
Indian Rd
Indian Gulch Rd
Inverleith Terr
La Salle Ave
La Salle Ct *
Lafayette Ave
Lexford Rd
Marlborough Ct *
Muir Ave
Sandringham Pl
Sandringham Rd
Sea View Ave
(Between La Salle & Crocker)
Selborne Dr
Somerset Rd
Sotelo Ave
St James Circle
St James Dr
St James Place
Trestle Glen Rd
Tyson Circle
Valant Place
Wildwood Gdns
Wistaria Way
Woodland Way
Wyngaard Ave

ZONE 2
Arroyo Ave
Bonita Ave
(North of Park Way)
Cambridge Way
(West of Grand Ave)
Estrella Ave
Grand Ave – *ODD*
(Bet Wildwood & Cambridge)
Grand Ave
(Between Cambridge & Rose including Lower Grand)
Greenbank Ave
(West of Grand Ave)
Holly Place
Howard Ave
Kingston Ave
Lake Ave
Linda Ave
Lorita Ave
Lower Grand Ave
Manor Dr
Monticello Ave
Nace Ave
Oakland Ave
(West of Grand Ave)
Olive Ave
Park Way
(Between Monticello & Bonita)
Parkside Dr *
Ramona Ave
Ronada Ave
Rose Ave
Sunnyside Ave
York Dr

ZONE 3
Arbor Dr
Artuna Ave *
Blair Ave
(Below Highland)
Bonita Ave
(South of Park Way)
Cambridge Way
(East of Grand Ave)
Carmel Ave
Dale Ave
Dracena Ave
El Cerrito Ave
Fairview Ave
Grand Ave – *EVEN*
(Between Wildwood & Cambridge)
Greenbank Ave
(East of Grand Ave)
Highland Ave
(North of Mountain Ave)
Highland Way
Hill Lane *
Hillside Ave
Hillside Ct **(Hand Blow)*
Jerome Ave
Keefer Ct *
Larmer Ct *
Latham St
MacKinnon Pl *
Magnolia Ave
Moraga Ave
(West of Highland)
Nova Dr
Oakland Ave
(Between Grand & Highland)
Park View Ave
(Between Magnolia & 241 Park View)
Park Way
(Between Bonita & Highland)
Ricardo Ave
San Carlos Ave
Sylvan Way
Vista Ave
Waldo Ave

ZONE 4
Abbott Way *
Alta Ave
Bell Ave
Bellevue Ave
Blair Ave
(Above Highland)
Blair Place *
Calvert Ct
Craig Ave
Dormidera Ave
Dudley Ave
Dudley Ct *
Echo Lane *
Hagar Ave
Hardwick Ave
Langdon Ct *
Littlewood Dr
Maxwelton Rd
Mesa Ave
Monte Ave
Moraga Ave
(East of Highland)
Mountain Ave
(West of Sharon)
Nellie Ave *
Oakland Ave
(Between Highland & Scenic)
Pacific Ave
Pala Ave
Park Way
(Between Highland & Pala)
Scenic Ave
Sharon Ave
Sharon Ct

ZONE 5
Annerley Rd
Boulevard Way
Caperton Ave
Crocker Ave
(North of La Salle Ave)
Crofton Ave
Farragut Ave
Guilford Rd
Hampton Rd
(West of Sea View Ave)
Harvard Rd
Hazel Lane
Highland Ave
(South of Mountain Ave)
King Ave
Lakeview Ave
Lincoln Ave
Mountain Ave
(East of Sharon)
Oak Rd
Oakmont Ave
Palm Dr
Park Lane
Park View Ave
(Between 241 Park View & Winsor)
Piedmont Ct *
(Hand Blow)
Poplar Way
Portsmouth Rd
Prospect Rd
Ranleigh Way
Requa Pl
Requa Rd
Richardson Way
Sea View Ave
(Between Mountain & La Salle)
Sheridan Ave
Sierra Ave
Wallace Rd
Warfield Ave
Wildwood Ave
Winsor Ave

Subscribe to *Street Sweeping Email Updates* (https://lp.constantcontactpages.com/su/2tJcrMR/streetsweepalerts) to get reminders about upcoming street sweeping dates. The Piedmont Public Works Department sends out the weekly schedule to this list every Sunday during street sweeping season.

Street sweeping tips for residents

To help Piedmont's Department of Public Works keep the streets free of leaves during the fall and winter months, residents are asked to observe four rules:

1. Do not put branches in the street, even small branches! They damage the street sweeping equipment.
2. Do not sweep debris from your yard into the gutter – sweep only leaves that fall naturally into the street.
3. Sweep leaves into narrow rows outside the flow line of the gutter. Do not put them in piles. The street sweepers cannot pick up piles of leaves effectively.
4. If you want to rake your leaves, you can now add them to your weekly unlimited green waste cart. If you don't have enough room in your cart, free compostable bags are available at City Hall to place with your green cart on garbage day. Do not bag them and then empty the bags on the street on sweeping day. Compostable bags are also available from Republic Services (1-800-320-8077) for a fee.



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PPD Blue

Excerpts from the Piedmont Police Department Log

Sept. 25 - Oct. 2

The Week by the Numbers
1 Residential Burglary
1 Fraud Report
2 Vandalism Report
3 ALPRs triggered (Automatic License Plate Readers)
4 Automotive Burglaries
4 Arrests

Friday, September 25

5:07 p.m. Muir Ave. Report of skunk on side of house. Skunk captured and released.

6:37 p.m. Grand Ave. **Arrest. ALPR** triggered by stolen 2009 Ford Escape. Officer locates vehicle, occupant arrested for possession of stolen vehicle and taken to Santa Rita Jail.

Saturday, September 26

7:31 a.m. Lower Grand Ave. Report of alarm sounding since 4 a.m. Faulty smoke detector in truck; detector silenced.

3:41 p.m. Crocker Ave. Multiple reports of peaceful protest.

8:44 p.m. Wildwood Ave. **Arrest.** Report of man with backpack and flashlight in park rifling around. Officer finds person in triangle park area sitting on park bench. Person has outstanding warrants for DUI. Search finds narcotics with intent to distribute and paraphernalia. Suspect arrested and taken to Santa Rita Jail.

Sunday, September 27

4:34 p.m. Wildwood Ave. Report of vehicle crashing into tree. Occupant has minor injuries; vehicle towed.

Monday, September 28

8:48 a.m. Grand Ave. **Fraud.** Report of identity theft; email hacked.

1:09 p.m. Grand Ave. Report of man spitting at customers. Officer on scene, person refuses services and leaves premises.

3:19 p.m. Grand Ave. **Arrest.** Report of man without shirt disturbing the peace out front of Ace Hardware. Officers find intoxicated man stumbling and smelling of alcohol. Man identified and found to have warrants out of San Francisco County for sex offender registration, trespassing and vandalism. Man arrested and taken to Santa Rita Jail.

Tuesday, September 29

10:58 a.m. King Ave. **Auto Burglary.** Report of window smashed on parked vehicle. Vehicle rifled through; unknown loss.

2:37 p.m. Manor Dr. Officer locates stolen unoccupied black 2016 Mercedes. Vehicle stolen from Albany; owner notified.

3:12 p.m. Farragut Ave. **ALPR** triggered by blue Hyundai Sonata. Officer locates vehicle unoccupied. Officer attempts to contact owner.

8:43 p.m. Boulevard Way. **Auto Burglary.** Report of Kia Sorento rifled through. Vehicle parked in driveway. Coins and umbrella taken.

Wednesday, September 30

11:51 a.m. Hillside Ave. **Auto Burglary.** Report of rear plate stolen from Honda CRV.

4:03 p.m. Grand Ave. Report of dog biting a squirrel. Squirrel injured but runs away.

4:41 p.m. Fairview Ave. Report of Amazon truck speeding.

Thursday, October 1

7:41 a.m. Highland Ave. Bullets turned into PD for destruction on 9/24.

7:52 a.m. Howard Ave. **Vandalism.** Report of graffiti on Oakland Ave, bridge. Transient woman has green marker in her hand. Officer locates person; she is taken to hospital.

8:30 a.m. Lakeshore Ave. **ALPR** triggered by blue 2008 Toyota Tundra. Vehicle wanted for previously evading police as sideshow spectator.

9:10 a.m. Winsor Ave. **Auto Burglary.** Report of Honda Odyssey rifled through. No loss and no damage.

6:33 p.m. Highland Ave. **Fire.** Report of smoke coming from second floor of residence. Person fell asleep while cooking. Food taken off heat. Officer helps with ventilation of residual smoke.

See PPD Blue on page 25

PICK OF THE WEEK

• *Found bound hound sound*

Monday, September 28

4:19 p.m. Grand Ave. Report of large gray and white dog howling. Dog stuck between dividing wall. Unknown how long dog has been stuck. Dog freed, call canceled.



"Congratulations, Richard. Dude says you've almost kissed your way up to a partnership."

Sports

PHS volleyball team beats Castro Valley – first time since 2018

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's girls' volleyball team claimed a big 3-0 sweep of Castro Valley on Thursday, October 1 at Binks Rawlings Gym, improving their record to 14-8 with five matches left in the regular season. The victory marked the school's first win over the Trojans since 2018, a testament to the program's progress over the last two years.

"Castro Valley may have been undermanned, but we didn't blink or let off. We had strong play in all three sets, and that's what we want. The girls stayed really focused," co-head coach Mike Glass said.

This year's volleyball team is already among the school's best in the last decade based its record. Their 14 wins is the most since 2017 when the team went 16-8. Other top teams in school history include 2013 when they went 19-11, the 2012 team (18-15), 2009 (22-9), and 2008's all-time best team that went 24-6 and reached the D4 North Coast Section Championship.

Piedmont hasn't won an NCS game since 2015, making that the goal of this year's team.

"We're making steady progress. There's a lot we still want to work on, so we just want to keep doing our best to improve. I think we're playing our best right now. We have moments where we lock in against our top competition, so we want to see that all the time," Glass said.

"Year after year, the Piedmont program is strengthening more and more. In this game, we came out with a bunch of energy every single set. We just played our own game," junior middle hitter Lucia Dorsey mentioned.

Against Castro Valley, PHS was without starting outside hitters Fiona Olsen and Sofia Meyer. It led to big games by Dorsey with 10 kills, Nora Trombi with seven kills, and Olivia Stevens with five. Glass called Dorsey's performance her best of the season.

"Where a lot of the power came from was from Corina [Vora's] sets. She encouraged some of our plays between me and Maika [Ting]. My chemistry with the setters is becoming super strong," Dorsey said.



Staff Photos

Lucia Dorsey had 10 kills in Piedmont's win vs. Castro Valley.



Nora Trombi had seven kills against the Trojans.



Olivia Stevens had five kills against Castro Valley.

Match Recap

Piedmont won by scores of 25-21, 25-17, 25-17 over the visiting Trojans.

In the first set, Piedmont trailed 4-2 before scoring four straight points to take a 6-4 advantage and never relinquished the lead. Both teams traded points with PHS holding an 18-14 lead, then scored on three straight kills by Izara Dando, and two by Trombi. Castro Valley closed the gap to 23-20, but Piedmont scored two of the final three points with kills by Trombi and Dorsey.

PHS opened to a 5-1 lead in the second set, but CV battled back to take a 6-5 lead. The Highlanders regained the lead at 7-6 and maintained their advantage from then on. After that, Piedmont scored seven of nine points to take a commanding 14-9 lead and extended to 21-13. They finished with four of the closing eight points to win 25-17.

Castro Valley started with a 4-2 lead in the third set, but Piedmont took control with a run nine straight points with two kills by Maika Ting. CV inched closer to 12-7 but PHS scored three straight with kills by Ting and a block by Dorsey

Final stats: Ting had 13 kills and 11 digs. Charlotte Bailey had three kills, two blocks and one dig. Dando had three kills and seven digs. Trombi had seven kills and two digs. Stevens had five kills, two aces, and 14 digs. Dorsey had 10 kills, one ace, and one block.. Allyson Huynh had 16 digs and four assists. Corina Vora had two aces, nine digs and 25 assists. Hazel Schaeffer had 11 digs. Mia Bechtel had one ace, four digs and seven assists.

Tuesday vs. Alameda

Piedmont visited Alameda on Tuesday, October 6. See next week's *Post* for match details.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (14-8 overall, 3-2 league) hosts league rival Bishop O'Dowd on Thursday, October 8 at 6:30 p.m.

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Athletes of the Month: Maika Ting & Henry Stein

Honorable Mention: Maddy Huynh, Dylan Jerez



Staff Photos

Maika Ting earns girls' Athlete of the Month for September for her impact as the volleyball team's leading outside hitter.

By Jonathan Comeaux

We have now rolled through the first month of school. With our first Athlete of the Month of the new school year, we're awarding Maika Ting of girls' volleyball and Henry Stein of boys' water polo our two Athletes of the Month for September. Honorable mentions go to Maddy Huynh of girls' tennis and Dylan Jerez of boys' water polo.

MAIKA TING

Maika Ting earns Athlete of the Month for September after leading the girls' volleyball team in kills in every match this season. Some of her best performances include 24 kills and six aces in a 3-2 loss to Salesian on September 3, 13 kills and three aces in a 3-1 win over San Leandro on September 8, 17 kills in a 3-0 win over Encinal on September 22, and 16 kills in a 3-1 loss to Bishop O'Dowd on September 23.

HENRY STEIN

Henry Stein earns Athlete of the Month for September for filling the stat sheet in multiple categories for the boys' water polo team. Some of his best games include nine goals, one assist, and two steals in a 12-11 loss to San Marin on September 19, five goals and three assists in a 9-8 loss to Clayton Valley on September 18, five goals and two assists in an 11-8 victory over Marin Catholic on September 18, and four goals, an assist, and three steals in a 14-6 win over Encinal on September 24.

See Athletes of the Month on page 28

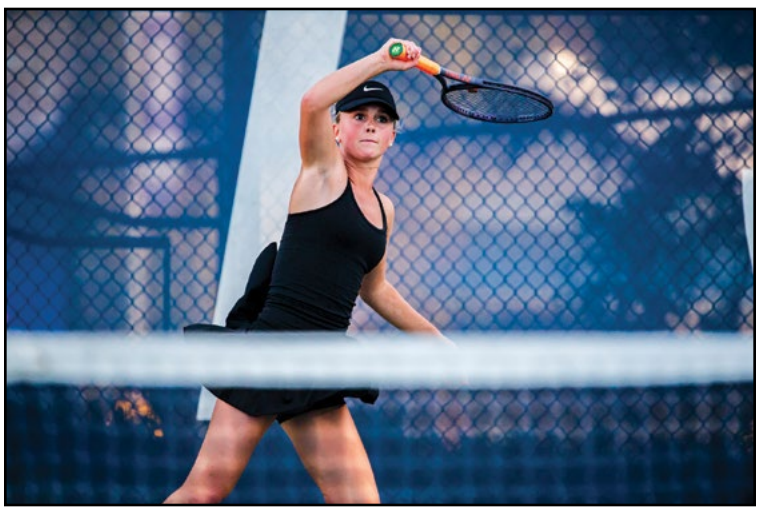


Henry Stein earns boys' Athlete of the Month for September for filling the stat sheet in multiple categories for boys' water polo.



Tennis player Maddy Huynh earns an honorable mention for her impact as a freshman singles starter.

Girls tennis team tops College Prep, Castro Valley



Staff Photos

Ella Ruthven had wins against College Prep and Castro Valley, but fell in three sets to Head-Royce.

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's girls' tennis team won two of its last three matches last week. They beat North Coast Section foe College Prep 6-1 on Tuesday, September 29 at the Corey Reich Tennis Center, but lost 4-3 to NCS rivals Head-Royce at home the following day. They wrapped up the week with a 6-1 Western Alameda County Conference win on the road over Castro Valley on Thursday, October 1.

The win over CV maintains Piedmont's undefeated 3-0 league record. Head-Royce, was notably last year's No. 9 seed in the D1 NCS Team Tournament, while PHS was No. 12.

"We're still in the hunt for another league title, Alameda will be the competition. This was a good result against Head-Royce, they are a good team," coach Jim Landes said.

Piedmont won last year's WACC title with a 7-1 record. At 3-0, it sets up a critical October 14 match against the Hornets.

"We all really want it and have been playing really well as a team. We lost a lot of seniors from last year's team, but I think we're playing better than expected – at least for me, personally. But I think the team and myself is getting into a rhythm, so hopefully we can challenge for that title," junior Leela Sivakumar said.

6-1 over College Prep

The Highlanders won all four singles matches and two of three at doubles.

At singles, Ella Ruthven won 6-0, 6-2 at No. 1. Faith Chin won 6-0, 6-3 at No. 2, while Maddy Huynh had a 6-0, 6-0 sweep at No. 3. Sivakumar won 6-2, 7-6 (7-5) at No. 4.

Emma Chan and Chiara Silvio won 6-2, 6-2 at No. 1 doubles, while Layla Reed-Miguel and Mai Pham also had a double-bagel 6-0, 6-0 sweep at No. 3. Ella Thomasson and Paige Chin lost in three sets at No. 2, 4-6, 6-0, 10-3.

4-3 to Head-Royce

Piedmont won the three of the first four matches of the day, but lost the final three.

Amalia Angulo and Reed-Miguel fell 6-3, 6-1 at No. 3 doubles to start, but Piedmont ran off three straight wins after that. Sivakumar won 6-4, 6-2 at No. 2 singles, Huynh won 7-5, 6-1 at No. 3 singles, and Thomasson and Pham won 7-6 (7-3, 6-3) at No. 3.

See Tennis on page 28



Leela Sivakumar had wins against College Prep and Castro Valley.



Mai Pham helped capture wins against College Prep, Castro Valley, and Head Royce at No. 3 doubles.

Water polo team suffers two losses

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's boys' water polo team suffered two losses on the road over the past week, bringing their overall record to 6-8 overall and 1-2 against Western Alameda County Conference opponents. The Highlanders suffered a 17-10 loss at Acalanes on Thursday, October 1 and fell narrowly 13-12 at league foes Berkeley on Tuesday, September 29.

"We're getting game experience against bigger and faster players. The goal is to get game experience against better players so we can get more aggressive," coach Rik Krumins said.

Both of Piedmont's losses to Berkeley this season have come by just one goal after falling to the Yellowjackets 10-0 back on September 4. The result means Piedmont is currently tie for fourth-place in league with Castro Valley and Encinal ahead of the league tournament on October 27.

The Highlanders dominated Encinal 15-6 on September 24, and have two matches remaining against Castro Valley.

17-10 to Acalanes

The Dons, notably, achieved the No. 13 seed in last year's Division 1 North Coast Section bracket, while the Highlanders were No. 1 in the Division 2 ladder. Acalanes had a strong first half to lead 12-5 going into halftime. The Dons pulled ahead even further in the third with four goals to Piedmont's three, making it 16-8. PHS added two more goals in the fourth quarter and allowed one.

Final score-line and first-quarter goals was unfortunately not provided.

Final stats: Rylan Patty led with three goals. Henry Stein had two goals, three assists, and a steal. Henry Van Den Bos had two goals and an assist. Graham Smith had one goal, one assist, and a steal. Walker Wilson had a goal and a steal. Jack Dahling had an individual goal. Oliver Hurwitz had two steals, Mara Pasani had one steal, while Leo Maltz had one assist. Goalie Dylan Jerez had eight saves and eight steals.

13-12 to Berkeley

Both teams were tied 3-3 through the first quarter and 6-6 going into halftime. The Yellowjackets scored four goals and only conceded two in the third quarter to take a 10-8 advantage going into the fourth. PHS scored four goals in the final going, but Berkeley's three goals was enough to put them above.

Final stats: Patty led with eight goals and one steal. Stein had two goals, six assists, and five steals. Oliver Hurwitz had one goal and one steal. Van Den Bos scored an individual goal. Jerez had eight saves and two steals.



Staff Photos

Piedmont's boys' water polo team suffered two losses over the past week.



Rylan Patty led scoring against Acalanes and Berkeley, with respective goals of three and eight.



Goalie Dylan Jerez had eight saves and eight steals against Berkeley, to go along with eight saves and two steals vs, Acalanes.

Tuesday vs. Castro Valley

Piedmont hosted Castro Valley for a league match on Tuesday, October 6. See next week's Post for match details.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (6-8 overall, 1-2 league) play in the Monterey Tournament on Friday and Saturday, October 9-10. They face Pacific Grove on Friday at 1:00 p.m.

PIEDMONT SPORTS SCHEDULE

Some events subject to change. (Revised - 10/7/26)

Date	Day	Sport	Opponent	Loc.	Var.	JV.
Oct. 7	Wed.	TEN	Justin Sienna (Napa)	A/H	3:30	3:30
Oct. 8	Thurs.	VB	Bishop O'Dowd	H	6:30	5:30
		FF	Hayward	H	7:30	6:30
Oct. 9	Fri.	XC	Asics Clovis Invitational at Woodward Park, Fresno	A	7:45am	----
		WP-B	Monterey Bay Invitational Tournament vs. Pacific Grove	A	1:00	------
		FB	Arroyo	H	7:00	4:00
Oct. 10	Sat.	WP-B	Monterey Bay Invitational Tournament	A	TBD	------
Oct. 13	Tues.	WP-B	Lick-Wilmerding (San Francisco)	A	4:45	3:30
		FF	San Lorenzo	A	4:15	------
Oct. 14	Wed.	GG	Arroyo, Castro Valley at Lake Chabot GC	A	3:30	3:30
		TEN	Alameda	H/A	3:30	3:30
		VB	Berkeley	A	6:30	5:30

KEY: H = Home, A = Away, XC = Cross Country, FB = Football, FF = Flag Football, VB = Girls' Volleyball, WP-B = Boys' Water Polo, TEN = Girls' Tennis, GG = Girls' Golf

Piedmont competes in first league meet of season

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's cross country team traveled to Point Pinole Regional Park in Richmond for their first Western Alameda County Conference meet of the season on Wednesday, September 30. The boys' team finished fifth of nine schools, while the girls were fifth of eight.

"There were a lot of things to be encouraged about in these results. We had strong performances at the front of both teams, some very impressive performances from our younger runners, and, most importantly, quite a few runners making significant improvements. We still have plenty of work ahead of us, but it is great to see the training beginning to show up in the race results as we head into October," coach Steve Zirkelbach said.

Senior running Alex Schleuning led things for the boys' team, finishing seventh of 88 runners with a time of 16:26.1 on the three-mile course. It was the first time for the team to be led by a runner other than junior Dresden Schulte-Sasse in four events this season. Schulte-Sasse, meanwhile, was close behind Schleuning in 10th, clocking a 16:32.2.



Senior Alex Schleuning led Piedmont in their first WACC meet of the season.

"Alex Schleuning led Piedmont with a great race. Dresden Schulte-Sasse was right behind him 10th overall. Dresden improved by an impressive 53 seconds from his previous 17:25 on the same course," Zirkelbach said.



Freshman Cormac Ross rounded helped the scoring with the fifth-fastest time.



Viviane Oesterer led Piedmont's girls' varsity team for the third time this season.

Next in for Piedmont was sophomore Dylan Wallway finishing 17th in 17:12.1, while rounding out their best-five was freshman Cormac Ross in 40th in 18:19.1 and sophomore Blake Riif behind him in 41st, 18:29.4.

"Freshman Cormac Ross continued his strong first season, running 18:19 as our fourth Varsity runner. Blake Riiff also continued his significant improvement this season, taking 37 seconds off his previous three-mile time," Zirkelbach said.

As for the girls' team, they continue to work without star runners like Leighton Mand, Amalia Gray, and Kelsey Coleman. Junior Viviane Oesterer placed 14th of 68 runners, clocking a time of 20:19.1, and has now led the Highlanders in three of its four events this season.

"On the girls' side, Viviane Oesterer led Piedmont with a strong run. She improved her previous time on this course by 13 seconds," Zirkelbach said.

Behind Oesterer was senior Cora Brozowski Schrader finishing 18th in 20:45.1, junior Nikita Gorelik in 27th in 21:00, sophomore Camille Hauser in 34th in 21:19.8, while senior Annie Thornton rounded out their best five times in 46th, 22:56.5.

"Viviane was followed by Cora Brozowski Schrader, Nikita Gorelik, and Camille Hauser. Our first four girls were separated by exactly one minute, which is great to see as this group continues to develop. One of the biggest improvements of the meet came from Annie Thornton, who ran nearly two full minutes faster than her previous time on the course," Zirkelbach said.

NEXT UP

Piedmont competes in the 47th annual Asics Clovis Invitational at Woodward Park on Friday and Saturday, October 9-10. The boys' varsity team runs at 7:40 a.m. on Friday, while the girls compete at 10:00 a.m. the same day.

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Flag football team dominates American 53-6



Staff Photos

Piedmont dominated American 53-6, improving their league record to 6-4 and y close to clinching a North Coast Section berth. Pictured are Naiya Alexander (left), Edie Elmquist, and Skye Prata Baack.

By Jonathan Comeaux

It was a big night for the flag football team when hosting American on Thursday, October 1, The Highlanders beat the visiting Eagles by a one-sided 53-6 score. The result improves Piedmont's record to 7-8 overall and 6-4 against Western Alameda County Conference Shoreline Division competition.

With four games left in the regular season, Piedmont needs one win to assure a .500 league record going into the WACC tournament on October 20.

"To be honest, I have not even spoke about NCS yet to the team. We've talked about our record in league and what we want to accomplish in the league, so our focus has been that. What I did talk to them about tonight is getting to the line, being intense, getting out quickly, and being prepared at the line. That intensity takes us into the rest of the season," coach Beth Black said.

One player who has emerged as a defensive leader is Nea Mafi as the team's new starting safety.

She's filling big shoes left by Class of 2026 starter Dahlia Osman, who finished her high school career with 24 interceptions. Mafi is often acting as the defense's signal caller, communicating with her other defensive teammates before the snap. She had an interception returned for a touchdown against American.

"She is a leader when she's on the field and on the sideline. She's constantly watching the game, and that's helping her improve," Black said of Mafi.

"I'm the safety and the last line of defense. It's important to keep up communication because I see what the game from a different angle at safety. In the beginning of the season, I wasn't as communicative. I didn't know exactly how to get my voice out, but I've gotten more and more comfortable with the team, so I slowly started to learn it's okay to be loud," Mafi said.

Game Recap

After American punted on its opening possession, Piedmont scored on its very first offensive play on a short pass to Naiya Alexander that turned into a 50-yard catch and run. The receiver weaved her way around three defenders to doge tackles on the play, sprinting to the end zone. PHS converted a one-point try on a pass from Edie Elmquist to Sydney Latvala to give them a 7-0 lead with 4:52 left in the first quarter.

With American pushed back to their own five, Piedmont's next score was an interception returned for a touchdown by Nea Mafi with 2:59 left. Elmquist completed a pass to Alexander for the one-point conversion, making it 14-0.

PHS scored again with 1:22 left in the first. This time, Elquist found Latvala on a 15-yard pass, making it 20-0 after a missed extra point. American answered with its only touchdown with 7:01 remaining in the second quarter.

The Highlanders scored on its ensuing possession on a 10-play, 66-yard drive. They converted a 4th-and-3 in the process at the Eagles' 23 with an eight-yard run by Mafi and capped off with a nine-yard quarterback keeper by Elmquist. They converted another one-point try on a pass to Latvala, now 27-6 with 2:30 left.

They scored again with 8:36 left in the third quarter on a six-play, 66-yard series. This time, Skye Prata Baack made a nice catch on a near 10-yard pass by Elmquist for the score, making it 33-6 after a missed conversion.

Piedmont's final three touchdowns were not recorded due to an overlap in sports schedules. Details were not provided, but two scores were logged by Zoya Shulze and one by Latvala.



Naiya Alexander runs a ball into the end zone for a touchdown against American.



Nea Mafi running in her interception return for a touchdown against American.

HIKING WITH JON

Jaunts for a haunted Halloween

By Jonathan Comeaux

Spooky season has arrived with Halloween right around the corner. What better time to awaken some spooky history of around the area, including your very own town?

Here's a look into a batch of locations with rumors of a spooky past.

Tyson Lake, Piedmont

Tyson Lake is a small reservoir located between private residences between La Salle and Sotelo Avenues, tucked quietly behind the Hampton Field. The location is not public property, but is the only body of water in Piedmont a few locals are known to reel out some carp.

On July 20, 1951, the Oakland Tribune published that the Alameda County coroner's jury today recommended that Tyson Lake, an unused reservoir here, be either drained or properly fenced to prevent further accidents following the drowning of 17-year old James Richards four days earlier.

But near a year to the day of the first accident, a second victim on July 10 drowned in Tyson; 19-year old Donald Stracner after swimming with two other companions. World War 2 Navy diver John Haubner, who was a former Piedmont Police Officer, was called on to retrieve Stacner's body.

"As search for the body continued, Police Chief William Pflaum said he will "definitely recommend that some action be taken to alleviate this menace to life." He said that in view of the fact there have been two drownings in the lake within a year, "something must be done'," wrote the Oakland Tribune, via HistoryofPiedmont.com.

Later on August 8 of 1952, the City of Piedmont sought out to determine the owner of Tyson Lake following the drowning of Stracner. City Council urged the 20 home owners surrounding the lake to erect a fence

Tyson Lake now sits quant and quietly behind the lush homes of Sotelo and La Salle.



Photos courtesy of Thoughtsicle.com

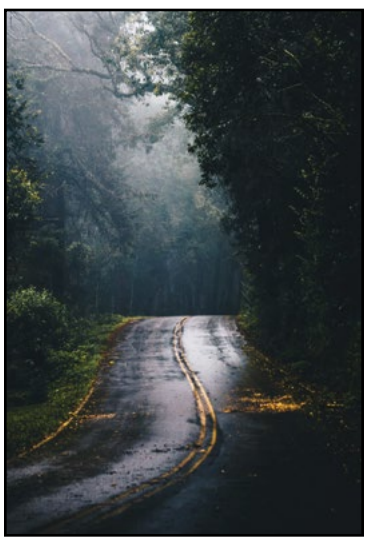
Tyson Lake is the only surface body of water in Piedmont. It is estimated to have 3 million gallons of water, and is the site of drowning victims more than half century ago in 1951 and 1952.



Calvin Adams, 19, who was swimming with Stracner at the time of the drowning, is disconsolate as he watches the dragging operations. Adams and another youth, Louis Jaramillo, 20, made a vain attempt to rescue Stracner.

Photo courtesy of HistoryofPiedmont.com

A clipping of a 1952 Oakland Tribune article of the search for Donald Stracner.

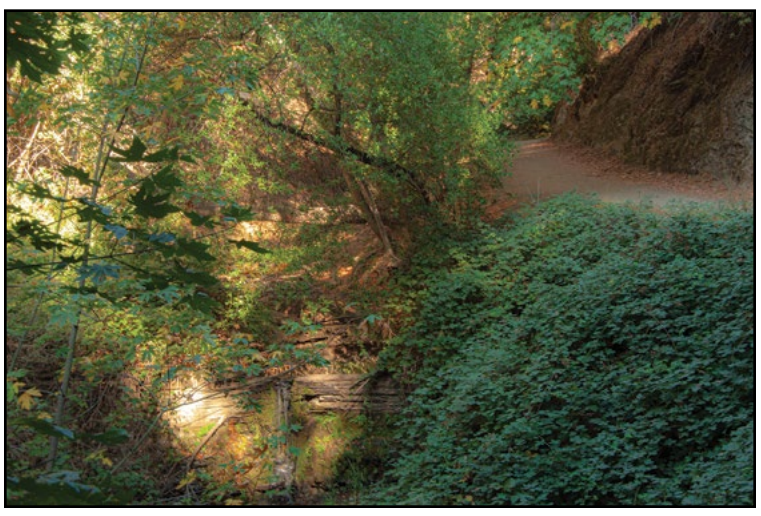


Niles Canyon in Fremont is home to a 100-plus year old urban legend of a vanishing hitchhiker on her way to San Francisco.

Hayward Plunge, Hayward

Allegedly, a swimming instructor back in the 1960s at the Hayward Plunge indoor pool led his entire class up the trail and left them in Ward Creek, telling them to wait until he returned. The children stayed there until the night; the coach returned and murdered them, leaving each of them in the creek. Many locals claim strange sightings, like voices of children around them—sometimes laughter or cries, sounds of footsteps pitter pattering, cold spots, and dark shadows. This writer even had a strange sighting of children in all-white garb from head-to-toe during the day as a teenager.

Starting at Memorial Park, the initial portion of the Hayward Plunge Trail starts in the back of the park past the bandstand. It travels for 1.3 miles slightly uphill alongside Ward Creek until intersecting with Campus Drive and Oaks Drive. Continue up Oaks Drive to continue the Hayward Plunge Trail. From there, the trail goes for another 1.6 miles to Durham Way and gains 600 feet in the process through the hills of Green Belt Park.



Staff Photo

A spillway along Ward Creek on the Hayward Plunge Trail, a notoriously haunted park in the East Bay.

Black Diamond Mines, Antioch

The Black Diamond Mines is a location of the White Witch or Wailing Witch, per urban legend. The story goes that a nanny was expelled from town in the 1870s for practicing witchcraft, only to turn up dead in the mines under suspicious circumstances. Other legend says a nanny, named Mary, was executed after being accused of witchcraft when all of the children under her watch died of illnesses.



Photo courtesy of East Bay Regional Parks

The Black Diamond Mines of Antioch is supposedly haunted by a presence known as the White Witch and Wailing Witch.

Niles Canyon, Fremont

The Niles Canyon ghost is an urban legend about young woman who died in a horse carriage accident over 100 years ago, said to have occurred specifically on February 28 when horses were spooked by two oncoming automobiles—throwing her from the carried. Legend has it a vanishing hitchhiker walks the road on that day every year, looking to hitch a ride to San Francisco

Moss Beach Distillery, Moss Beach

Grab a bite, a drink, a spectacular view, and a haunting story at the Moss Beach Distillery slightly past El Granada and Half Moon Bay. The "Blue Lady" is a story from over 70 years ago, where a young woman had an affair with a handsome piano player at the restaurant, falling in love with him. The lady in blue was said to have been murdered by her betrayed fiancé while walking on the beach below the restaurant.

Redwood Road Preschool, Oakland Hills

This one is very peculiar. Slightly past the intersection of Pinehurst and Redwood Road, there is a former preschool with a gruesome history. Legend has it, a knife wielding murder in the early 80s slayed an entire class of preschoolers on the grounds. Other reports from the *Gasden Times* indicated a man, Alan Robert Baer, was shot by police on the preschool property in 1981. All that is left of the school is the foundation and a lone swing set, while people have reported paranormal experiences of children's laughter, voices, and swings in full-motion as if the school yard was bustling.





Photo courtesy of MossBeachDistillery.com

Moss Beach Distillery is home of the "Blue Lady," who was a woman murdered by her scorned fiancé 70 years ago.

Arts & Entertainment

Festival Opera presents *Mad Scenes* at PCA on Oct. 25

By Allyson Aleksey

Festival Opera's Salon Series continues October 25 with *Mad Scenes*, a concert featuring sopranos Aura Veruni and Lila Khazoum and pianist Daniel Lockert at the Piedmont Center for the Arts.

The 4 p.m. performance will feature scenes from operas including Mozart's *Idomeneo* and *The Magic Flute*, Verdi's *Macbeth*, Donizetti's *Anna Bolena* and *Lucia di Lammermoor,* and Ambroise Thomas' *Hamlet*.

The program will explore the darker and more theatrical side of opera, with costumes by designer Marina Polakoff and props incorporated into the performance to help tell the stories. The concert is scheduled just before Halloween and will highlight the macabre and unhinged elements of opera.

Audience members are invited to attend in costume.

Veruni and Khazoum are both acclaimed sopranos who will perform the featured scenes with Lockert accompanying on piano.

The concert is part of Festival Opera's three-concert Salon Series, which is presented at the Piedmont Center for the Arts. The series concludes November 22 with baritone Efraín Solís, making his Festival Opera debut, accompanied by San Francisco Opera pianist Marika Yasuda.

The Piedmont Center for the Arts is at 801 Magnolia Ave. in Piedmont.

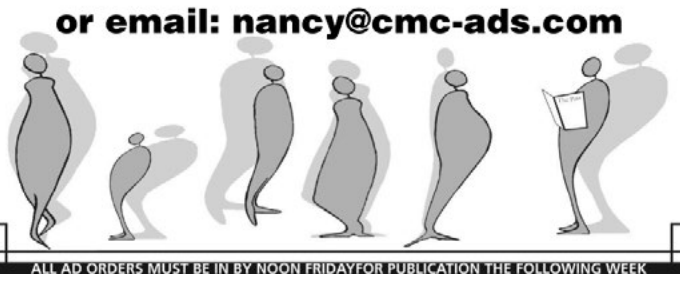
Tickets for the October 25 concert are $40. Visit festivalopera.org/salon-series to purchase tickets.



Lila Khazoum

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Autumn Lights Festival returns to Lake Merritt Oct. 15



This year's festival will feature more than 50 illuminated art displays. *Photo by John Kirkmire*

By Allyson Aleksey

Autumn Lights Festival, an art-filled and family-friendly fundraising event for the Friends of the Gardens at Lake Merritt (FGLM), returns this year on Thursday, October 15.

Now in its 15th year, the three-night festival brings illuminated art installations to the gardens surrounding Lake Merritt. The event has drawn more than 12,000 visitors since its launch in 2012.

This year's festival will feature more than 50 illuminated art displays throughout the gardens, along with live entertainment, an art market, children's activities and food and beverage vendors. Additional activities include a costume contest for children and adults, an artist awards program and a kids zone. The festival's food court will feature local food trucks and vendors, along with beer and wine gardens.

Proceeds from ticket sales benefit the Friends of the Gardens at Lake Merritt, a nonprofit volunteer organization formed in 2004. The organization works with the City of Oakland to support the maintenance, revitalization and programming of the gardens at Lakeside Park.

The seven-acre collection of themed gardens includes the Bonsai Garden, Sensory Garden, Toddler Garden and Urban Edible Garden, among others.

FGLM volunteers provide maintenance assistance as the city's gardening staff has been reduced over time. The Autumn Lights Festival is the organization's largest annual fundraiser.

Tickets and additional information are available through the Friends of the Gardens at Lake Merritt at https://gardensatlakemerritt.org/about/.

Filoli's "Nightfall Halloween" event runs through Nov. 1

By Allyson Aleksey

Filoli's "Nightfall Halloween" event is underway at the historic Woodside estate, with more than 53,000 tickets sold across its fall programs following a sold-out opening weekend.

"Nightfall" runs now through November 1 and is open from 5:30 to 10 p.m. The Halloween event features more than 1,000 illuminated jack-o'-lanterns, more than 200 scarecrows, character actors, food trucks and Halloween-themed attractions throughout Filoli's historic house and gardens.

New this year is a Witches' Village in the redwoods, featuring a 20-foot witches' cauldron, woven wicker witches, live banjo music and haunted railway conductors.

The new Haunted Railway includes more than 1,000 feet of track through the redwoods, with miniature houses and other handcrafted elements along the route.

Nightfall is in its third year as a large-scale Halloween event at Filoli. The event had sold more than 32,000 tickets before the end of summer, according to Filoli.

A Nightfall Champagne Lounge is also offered at 5:30, 7 and 8:30 p.m. The 60-minute experience in Filoli's Historic Ballroom includes three pours from a champagne flight and admission to Nightfall. Filoli said the Champagne Lounge also provides admission on some nights when general admission tickets have sold out.

During the day, Filoli is hosting Autumn Days through November 1 from 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. The daytime program includes a pumpkin patch, fall decorations, harvest games, seasonal food and drinks, and photo opportunities.

Tickets and information are available at www.filoli.org.



The Halloween event features more than 1,000 illuminated jack-o'-lanterns. *Photo courtesy of Filoli*

SF Playhouse presents *Peter Pan Goes Wrong*

By Allyson Aleksey

San Francisco Playhouse is presenting *Peter Pan Goes Wrong,* a comedy about an amateur theater company attempting to stage *Peter Pan* while a series of mishaps threatens to derail the production.

Written by Henry Lewis, Henry Shields and Jonathan Sayer, the play follows the fictional Cornley Polytechnic Drama Society as its members take on J.M. Barrie's classic story. The production features flying rigs, sword fights and a crocodile, along with forgotten lines, malfunctioning scenery and rivalries that spill onto the stage.

The play is by the creators of *The Play That Goes Wrong*, which similarly follows a fictional theater troupe whose production goes increasingly awry. *Peter Pan Goes Wrong* premiered in London in 2013 before later moving to the West End and Broadway.

Susi Damilano directs the San Francisco production. The cast includes Greg Ayers, Joe Ayers, Maggie Mason, Christian McCooey, Ezra Reaves, Renee Rogoff, Patrick Russell, Sophie Schulman, Terrance Austin Smith, Jomar Tagatac and Phaedra Tillery-Boughton, among others.

The production runs through November 28 at San Francisco Playhouse, 450 Post St. in San Francisco's Union Square neighborhood. Performances are Tuesday through Sunday, with evening and matinee performances on select days. The show runs approximately two hours and five minutes, including a 15-minute intermission, and is recommended for ages 8 and older.

Tickets and information for *Peter Pan Goes Wrong* and additional shows and musicals are available at sfplayhouse.org/.



Scene from *Peter Pan Goes Wrong.* *Photo by Jeremy Daniel*

Music at Kohl Mansion opens 44th season with Escher String Quartet



Escher String Quartet

By Allyson Aleksey

Music at Kohl Mansion will open its 44th season on October 18, with a performance by the Escher String Quartet, an internationally recognized chamber ensemble based in New York City.

The Escher String Quartet features Adam Barnett-Hart and Bryan Lee on violin, Pierre Lapointe on viola and Brook Speltz on cello. Formed in 2005 and named for Dutch graphic artist M.C. Escher, the quartet is known for performances combining technical precision, interpretive depth and a distinctive ensemble sound.

The program will feature three works from the string quartet repertoire: Haydn's *Quartet in G major, Op. 76, No. 1*; Shostakovich's *Quartet No. 3 in F major, Op. 73*; and Brahms' *Quartet in A minor, Op. 51, No. 2.*

The Escher String Quartet serves as Artists of the Chamber Music Society of Lincoln Center and has performed at venues and festivals including Wigmore Hall in London, the Concertgebouw in Amsterdam, the Kennedy Center in Washington, D.C., and the Auditorium du Louvre in Paris.

The ensemble has received several honors, including an Avery Fisher Career Grant and Lincoln Center's Martin E. Segal Award. Its recording projects have included the complete string quartets of composers Alexander Zemlinsky and Felix Mendelssohn.

The concert will begin at 7 p.m. at Kohl Mansion, 2750 Adeline Drive in Burlingame. A pre-concert talk by Stanford cellist and educator Christopher Costanza will begin at 6 p.m., followed by a complimentary glass of wine and dessert after the performance at 9 p.m.

Music at Kohl Mansion's 2026-27 season includes eight performances through May 2, 2027, featuring chamber music ensembles and artists from the United States and Europe. Performances take place in the historic Kohl Mansion, also known as The Oaks, which was built in 1914 and listed on the National Register of Historic Places in 1982.

Tickets and season subscriptions are available at www.musicatkohl.org.

SF Opera hosts two-day costume sale in Burlingame

Sale held Oct. 17–18

By Allyson Aleksey

San Francisco Opera hosts a costume collection sale in Burlingame October 17 and 18, offering shoppers the chance to purchase theatrical garments and accessories from decades of productions at the War Memorial Opera House.

The two-day sale will take place at the company's Scene Shop in Burlingame, with items ranging from Victorian dresses and Edwardian ensembles to 1920s fashions, military uniforms, capes and fantasy costumes.

The collection includes pieces from productions such as *Luisa Miller*, *Un Ballo in Maschera*, *Idomeneo*, *Fidelio* and *Don Giovanni*. Prices will range from $5 to $525, with premium items priced higher. Stage props and other opera merchandise will also be available.

The sale offers opportunities for collectors, performers and others seeking distinctive clothing for Halloween, Renaissance fairs, theatrical productions and masquerades.

San Francisco Opera periodically holds costume sales to make room for new productions. Proceeds from admission fees and sales will support the company.

The public sale will run from 9:30 a.m. to 6:30 p.m. both days, with the last entry at 4:30 p.m. Timed-entry tickets are required and include two hours of shopping. Admission ranges from $5 to $25, depending on the day and time.



Prices will range from $5 to $525. *Photo courtesy of San Francisco Opera*

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PEBCC celebrates "The Sound of Home" at 2026 benefit concert & auction

What does it mean to find your voice—and a place to belong? The Piedmont East Bay Children's Choir (PEBCC) will explore that question at its 2026 Benefit Concert & Auction, "The Sound of Home," at 6 p.m. on Saturday, October 10, at the DoubleTree by Hilton Berkeley Marina. The evening will celebrate extraordinary young singers and the community of families, educators, alumni, volunteers, accompanists, and supporters who make their musical journey possible.

Led by award-winning Artistic Director Eric Tuan, the evening will feature performances by PEBCC singers, including the Ensemble Choir, along with two special guest soloists: alumna Kate Offer, a classical singer and conductor, and PEBCC singer Naomi Walker, who recently received the 1st Prize Solo Competition award at the Golden Gate International Choral Festival. For Tuan, a world-class choral education is about far more than learning to sing.

"Choral music is one of the most powerful ways for young people to build connections with each other and the world around them," says Tuan. "Our singers learn to listen to each other, to share their voices in a way that empowers the whole team, and to explore different cultures and perspectives through the universal language of music. As our alumni remind us, those experiences last for a lifetime."

At the heart of PEBCC's mission is the belief that every young person should have the opportunity to experience that journey, regardless of financial circumstances. Financial assistance is central to the organization's commitment to building a community where every singer belongs.

The benefit concert supports that mission while celebrating the full circle of community surrounding the choir.

"Our singers are part of a community much bigger than themselves," says Tuan. "The transformative experiences singers experience wouldn't be possible without the alumni who come back to teach and volunteer, the families who support them through the program, and the supporters who give so generously of their time, talent, and treasure to ensure every singer finds a home at PEBCC."

Tickets are available at piedmontchoirs.org. PEBCC's Online Silent Auction opened Saturday, October 3, at 9:00 a.m. and closes Sunday, October 11, at 11:00 p.m.

The 2026 Benefit Concert & Auction is made possible through the generous support of Bell Investment Advisors, Commercial Bank of California, and Anonymous Foundation. Sponsorship helps PEBCC provide transformative musical experiences and keep many choir and festival events free and accessible, enriching the cultural life of the Bay Area. To learn about becoming a Benefit Sponsor, contact Natalie Titone at ntitone@piedmontchoirs.org.

Young People's Symphony Orchestra announces 90th anniversary



The Young People's Symphony Orchestra during their Finland & Sweden tour concerts.

The Young People's Symphony Orchestra (YPSO), California's oldest youth orchestra and the second-oldest in the United States, announces its landmark 90th Anniversary Season, celebrating nine decades of guiding young musicians toward excellence through orchestral music, education, and community. The 2026–27 anniversary season will feature four concerts spanning music from across centuries and cultures.

Founded in Berkeley in 1936 by conductor Jessica Marcelli, when women conductors were exceedingly rare, YPSO enters its 90th season following a successful concert tour of Finland and Sweden in June 2026. From its Berkeley roots, the orchestra has grown to bring together young musicians from across the San Francisco Bay Area. Today, under Music Director and Conductor David Ramadanoff, YPSO continues a tradition of challenging young musicians with great orchestral repertoire while fostering accomplishment, community, and a lifelong passion for music.

"I'm very proud to be part of an organization that has been providing young people the opportunity to play great music for 90 seasons," Ramadanoff said. "During my 38 years as Music Director, it has been exciting and heartwarming to help this orchestra develop into an outstanding ensemble capable of playing the wonderful and challenging music we have programmed this season."

The season starts with the fall concert on Saturday, November 7, 2026, at 7:30 p.m., at First Church Berkeley. YPSO will open its 90th season with Shostakovich's *Festival Overture*, Debussy's *Nocturnes*, and Brahms' *Symphony No. 1.*

The winter concert will take place on Saturday, February 20, 2027, at 7:30 p.m., at First Church Berkeley. The winter concert features Tchaikovsky's *Romeo and Juliet Fantasy-Overture*, Gabriela Lena Frank's *Three Latin American Dances*, and other works, including music by Ralph Vaughan Williams. The spring concert is on Saturday, May 1, 2027, at 7:30 p.m., at First Church Berkeley. They'll play Verdi's *Overture* to *La forza del destino*, Dvořák's *Symphony No. 6*, and additional repertoire.

The season culminates on Sunday, June 6, 2027, at 3 p.m. (venue TBA) with a special 90th Anniversary Pops Concert, bringing together current YPSO musicians with alumni from across generations of the orchestra's history. Former YPSO musicians will be invited to return, reconnect, and play alongside the next generation, celebrating the lasting community YPSO has built over nine decades.

The program is expected to feature Arturo Márquez's *Danzón No. 2* and a festive selection of audience favorites from stage and screen, creating a joyful celebration of YPSO's past, present, and future. The 2026–27 season honors YPSO's 90-year legacy by bringing together generations of musicians through the music and community that continue to connect them.

Enjoy all four concerts of YPSO's 90th Anniversary Season and save with a season package. Season packages are on sale now. The season package price for General is $70, and Premium is $100. Single Tickets for General are $25, and Premium are $35. Students are free, and registration is required. Premium tickets include an early seating benefit. Box office & concert information is available at ypsomusic.org/events.



Welcome to the Piedmont Center for the Arts

Ongoing through November 1

Oakland Art Association **gallery show**

Oakland Art Association presents *Hopes and Dreams* — a curated show that encompasses everyone's most precious and intimate desires for the future. It can be a dream vacation, a dream come true, a dream for the future of the world or just your part of it. Hope knows no bounds: hope for change, for healing, a brighter future, or for world peace. OAA is a nonprofit group of artists, photographers, and art supporters in Alameda and Contra Costa Counties whose mission is to encourage artistic endeavor in the community, support public school art education, and arrange show venues for our members' artworks. Free and open to all! For more information, see www.oaklandart.org. Gallery is open and staffed Saturdays and Sundays from 11 a.m. to 2 p.m.

Friday, October 9, 6:00 p.m.

Michael Stehr **Art History Lecture**

A Friday night Extravaganza! Art historian **Michael Stehr** presents a spirited, illustrated 50-minute lecture exploring Michelangelo's work in his hometown of Florence, Italy. At the age of 29, he would put the finishing touches on his David, likely one of the most recognizable sculptures in Western Art. As he moved through his forties, this sculptor, painter, architect, and poet of the High Renaissance would continue to yield sculptural masterpieces and explore the art of architecture at San Lorenzo, the parish church of the Medici family. In 1534, he moved to Rome and only returned to Florence after his passing almost another thirty years later. Doors open at 5:30 p.m. $20 (cash only).

Saturday, October 10, 7:00 p.m.

Virginia Tichenor's Ragtime Quartet **Concert**

This quartet features ragtime *pianist* **Virginia Tichenor** with a stellar line-up of musicians performing ragtime and traditional jazz music. The quartet includes Virginia, of course; **Ryan Calloway**, *clarinet, banjo and vocals*; **Marty Eggers**, *tuba*; and **Robert Young**, *cornet*. Virginia Tichenor is an Oakland-based pianist, originally from St. Louis, MO, the daughter of the late Trebor Tichenor, a noted scholar, pianist and collector of ragtime music. Virginia plays solo piano locally in the Bay Area and is also a traditional jazz pianist, working currently with her husband, Marty Eggers, who also plays with the Zenith, Silver Bell, and Barrelhouse Jazz Bands. Advance tickets are highly recommended for this show, and available now at https://www.ticketsignup.io/Ragtime.

Sunday, October 11, 4:30 p.m.

In the Tradition **Jazz & Pop Piano Trio**

The ***In the Tradition*** Piano Trio – **Bill Jackman**, **Mark Williams**, and **Albert Brooks** – will pay tribute to Jimmy Van Heusen, who composed nearly 1,000 songs between 1930 and 1970, of which 50 or more have become American standards. Don't miss the relaxed pleasure of an afternoon in the Classic Jazz Club with the trio. Tickets $25 + fee at https://www.ticketsignup.io/JVH, or $30 at the door. Doors open at 4:15 PM.

Friday, October 16, 7:00 p.m.

String, Skin, & Breath **Band Concert**

String, Skin, & Breath creates contemporary chamber music rooted in global traditions, blending ancient musical languages with modern expression. Drawing from Latin and North African modes, Ethio-jazz, desert blues, and global folk traditions, the ensemble weaves hypnotic rhythms, spacious improvisation, and rich acoustic textures into immersive performances that feel both timeless and new. The group exists to create a space for spontaneous, deep-listening musical conversation across cultures—stripping music down to its most elemental ingredients, honoring rhythm, vibration, and breath as the shared language beneath every tradition. The intention is to craft unrepeatable performances that move fluidly between meditative stillness and intricate rhythmic interplay, guided by trust and collective intuition rather than rigid arrangement—treating music-making itself as an act of human connection and cross-cultural dialogue. The band includes Uzbek-American cellist **Misha Khalikulov**, Latin-Grammy-nominated multi-instrumentalist **Daniel Riera**, percussionist/educator **Aaron Kierbel**, and Tunisian qanun virtuoso **Arslen Metouii**. Tickets available at https://www.ticketsignup.io/SSB.

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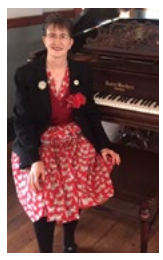
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SATURDAY, OCTOBER 10, 2026

(DOORS OPEN AT 6:30) 7:00 P. M.

This quartet features ragtime pianist Virginia Tichenor with a stellar line-up of musicians performing ragtime and traditional jazz music. The quartet includes Ryan Calloway, clarinet, banjo and vocals; Marty Eggers, tuba, and Robert Young, cornet. Virginia Tichenor is an Oakland-based pianist, originally from St. Louis, MO, the daughter of the late Trebor Tichenor, a noted scholar, pianist and collector of ragtime music. Virginia plays solo piano locally in the Bay Area and is also a traditional jazz pianist, working currently with her husband, Marty Eggers, who also plays with the Zenith, Silver Bell, and Barrelhouse Jazz Bands.





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String, Skin, & Breath creates contemporary chamber music rooted in global traditions, blending ancient musical languages with modern expression. Drawing from Latin and North African modes, Ethio-jazz, desert blues, and global folk traditions, the ensemble weaves hypnotic rhythms, spacious improvisation, and rich acoustic textures into immersive performances that feel both timeless and new, creating a space for spontaneous, deep-listening musical conversation across cultures—stripping music down to its most elemental ingredients, honoring rhythm, vibration, and breath as the shared language beneath every tradition. **This is music-making treated as an act of human connection and cross-cultural dialogue.**

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tenor



RACHEL COOKE
soprano



KAREN HUTCHINSON
piano



MICHAEL LONG
violin



VICKY EHRLICH
cello



PAUL EHRLICH
viola



JANET ARCHIBALD
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Newly-minted *Land's End Folk Ensemble* is a collaboration of Bay Area classical musicians exploring American and British Isles folk music tradition. With expertise honed in the symphony hall and on the opera stage, the ensemble combines the precision and discipline of orchestral playing with the flexibility and spontaneity of folk traditions. Folk music invites a different conversation: one rooted in simplicity, and the joy of community. This inaugural concert celebrates the unique moment when experienced orchestral players become students of a musical tradition that is both familiar and fundamentally different.

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FEATURES

Walking on Wednesday

Wednesday Walkers discover that "Nace is Nice!"

By Ken Hubbert

Braving another warm day on Sept. 30, the last day of the month, 50 members of the Piedmont Recreation Department's Walking on Wednesdays group and five of their canine companions gathered at the Exedra excited to see if Nace Avenue really is nice.

Leading our walk and tour was Pat Keller, a long-time Piedmont resident and Wednesday walker. Having lived on Nace Avenue for years, Pat was well qualified to relate the history of the area and provide information about some of the homes.

We began the walk heading in the direction of Dracena Park. As we walked through the park on our way to Nace, Park Commissioner Jack Fischrup noted that there are now four great horned owls in residence.

Nace is a tiny street with 27 houses. One unusual feature of Nace is that it's L-shaped, making a 90-degree turn toward the middle. The street was named after Frank C. Havens' secretary, John Nace. At the time, it was common to name streets after the people who were involved in developing the city. Nace is now a popular street for young families, with approximately 28 kids on it.

The first house we visited was 22 Nace. It was built in 1906 for $2,820. We were fortunate enough to encounter one of the owners, KT, who graciously invited us to come into her magnificent backyard. It's a breathtaking and fun little surprise when you enter the rear. The first thing you notice is the immensity of the outdoor living space with beautiful views of Piedmont. In addition there was a hot tub surrounded by redwood decking, a wooden, round-shaped sauna with a cold plunge adjacent, and an outdoor shower. To top things off, an inviting outdoor cabana with sofas tempted some of the walkers to sit and relax.

Leaving 22 Nace, we walked down the street to 42 Nace, which has an uncommon flat roof. Pat explained to the group that a fire in the 1950s destroyed the original pitched roof which was then replaced by the flat roof.

Continuing just next door, we visited 46 Nace, the present residence of Dave and Kathy Yam. Known as the "Gibson house," it was built in 1910 by the Fenton family of ice cream fame. The original house had lath and plaster walls and the beams were first generation old-growth redwood.

The Smith family moved in around 1912 and the home remained in the family until 1991 (79 years!). It is reported that they planted the large Catalpa tree out front, which is now a Piedmont Heritage Tree. However, a neighbor, Mrs. Gibson, claimed to have grown up at 46 Nace and her father planted the tree. Winnifred inherited the house and married Orrin Smith sometime between 1940 and 1950. They had no children, but all of the family celebrations were held at the house. Orrin was a wood shop teacher at McClymonds High School in Oakland and had a great workshop in the basement. The shelves and drawers for storing hardware were built by his students as a shop project.

Orrin and Winnifred remodeled the house extensively both inside and outside, excavating a basement and using the surplus soil to level the backyard. Next, they dug out the front and built a garage. In 1976, Winnifred started the "Nace is Nice" block party to celebrate the Fourth of July. The current owner, Kathy, inherited the block party tradition and revived it in the 1990s.

When Winnifred passed away, her sister Barbara became the executor of the estate. Barbara was the mother of one of Kathy Yam's best friends. At the time, Kathy and her husband Dave were looking for a home to buy since their daughter Amy was about to begin kindergarten. Fortunately for Dave and Kathy, Barbara agreed to sell the house in time for Amy's schooling.

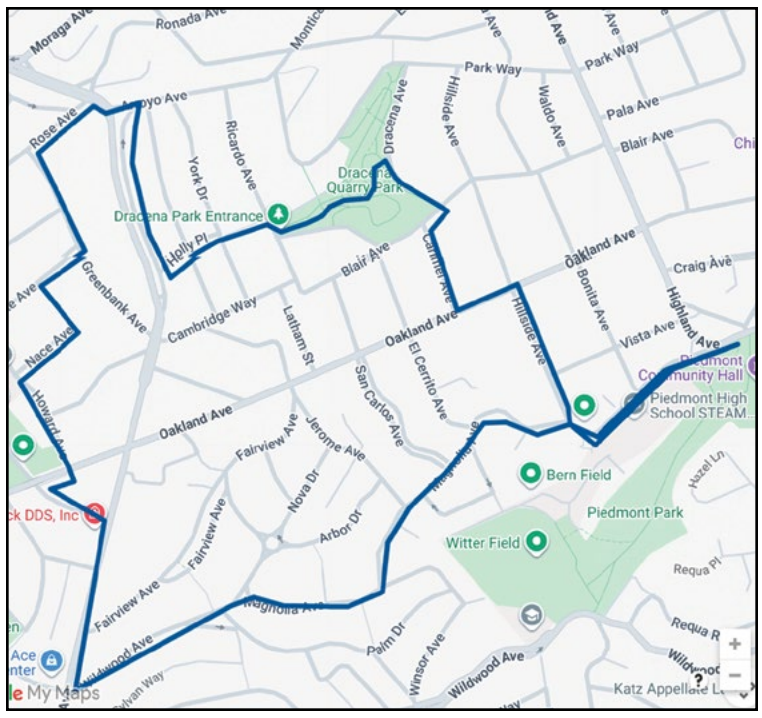
Since moving in, Dave and Kathy have extensively remodeled the house: adding a deck to the back, building a second story, re-shingling, constructing interior stairs to the basement, and assembling a new roof for the garage. In 2021, the house received the Design Award in the Excellence in Architecturally Consistent Design Category from the City. The added garage was the winner of the City's Excellence in Integrated Garage Design in 2024. Dave provided the group with ink-on-linen drawings of the original house plans, as well as two photo albums of the 1950 remodel.

Crossing the street to our final stop, we ended our tour at 35 Nace, the home of Greg and Pat Keller. Walkers were directed into a lushly landscaped backyard. Beneath a slatted roof arbor, a table of ice cold water, chocolate chip cookies and chocolate cake were waiting. Enough sustenance to fuel the walkers on their uphill hike back to their Exedra start.

All the walkers agreed, Nace is really nice!!!

For further reading, "Queen of the Hills: The Story of Piedmont, A California City" by Evelyn Craig Pattiani mentions on page 92 a Mabel Nace.

Walking on Wednesday meets weekly at 10:30 a.m. at the Exedra. The program is free and open to the public. Registration with the Piedmont Recreation Department is required at https://tinyurl.com/3ethkehu.



Route map



Among those participating were Denny McGee, Jim Kuo, Deborah Curtin with K-9 best friend Brie, Mike Henn with K-9 best friend Roger, Marion Lim Yankowitz, Jim Kellogg, Liz Dalrymple, Mark Davis, Lisa Euphrat, Stacy Venetluhmamm, Judy Love, Susie Backer, Caskey Weston, Marianne Jakus, Sherry Jacobs, Peggy Shultz, Noemi Alvarado, Quincy Dong, Juliane Jacqueline, Debbie Powell, Judy Wang, Cathy Laymon, Stella Houston, Lois Price, Brenda Ferrero, Matt Gerhardt, Pat Keller, Helen Dong, Claudine Bach, Albert Chen, Irene Thompson, Tom Lehrkind, Mike Gallant, Joan Jung with K-9 best friend JT, Dan Scdonis, Dave DeRoche with K-9 best friend Pepper, Ken Hubbert, Joyce Ahern, Jack Fischrup with K-9 best friend Kojak, and Nancy DeRoche. The group was pleased to welcome Norman and Carol Quan, Holly Hansen with K-9 best friend Ginger, and Adam Hundt who were walking with them for the first time.

The Wine Corner

Savoie: France's Alpine wines

By Pierre DuMont

High in the French Alps, where vineyards cling to steep slopes beneath snow-capped peaks, the wines of Savoie are gaining attention for their distinctive character and sense of place.

For generations, Savoie's vineyards have been closely tied to the region's mountain communities. Today, a new generation of winemakers is bringing renewed energy to an area once known primarily to French locals and Alpine holidaymakers. The result is a collection of wines that can be remarkably fresh, mineral-driven and unlike those produced in France's better-known regions.

White wines dominate Savoie's production, with the Jacquère grape playing a central role. Light-bodied and crisp, Jacquère produces wines with lively acidity and subtle floral and citrus notes, making them natural companions to local mountain cuisine. Altesse, another important white grape, produces the more structured and aromatic wines known as Roussette de Savoie. My favorite wine is Chignin-Bergeron, which is made from the Rhone Valley's Roussanne grape.

The region also has its own red specialties. Mondeuse, a traditional local grape, creates deeply colored wines with bright acidity, peppery spice and dark-fruit flavors. Gamay and Pinot Noir are also planted, adding further variety to the region's offerings.

Savoie's geography is central to its identity. Vineyards are scattered across valleys and foothills, often at considerable elevations. The cool Alpine climate allows grapes to ripen slowly while retaining the acidity that gives the wines their characteristic freshness.

That freshness is particularly well suited to Savoie's traditional foods: fondue, raclette, tartiflette and other rich mountain dishes. The wines cut through the richness of the cheese and potatoes, creating a pairing that reflects the region itself.

As interest in distinctive, terroir-driven wines continues to grow, Savoie is increasingly finding a place on the international wine map. Its bottles offer something increasingly sought after by modern wine drinkers: wines with a strong sense of origin, tradition and landscape.

Philippe Viallet: a family name in Savoie wine

At the foot of Mont Granier in France's Alpine Savoie region, the name Philippe Viallet has become closely associated with the area's distinctive wines. The family wine story began in 1966, when Marcel and Yvonne Viallet acquired a small vineyard in Apremont. Their sons, Pierre and Philippe, later continued the family business, with Philippe helping to develop it into both a wine producer and wine merchant.

The Viallet range reflects the diversity of Savoie's mountain vineyards. Among its best-known wines is Apremont, made from the Jacquère grape. It is a light, crisp and refreshing white wine with bright acidity. Another important wine is Chignin-Bergeron, made from the Roussanne grape and generally fuller and more aromatic, with flavors of ripe fruit and flowers.

Roussette de Savoie, made from the Altesse grape, offers another distinctive style, while the winery's red wines include Mondeuse, one of Savoie's traditional varieties, as well as Pinot Noir and Gamay.

The winery also produces Crémant de Savoie, a sparkling wine, along with rosé wines.

Philippe Viallet's wines offer a taste of the Alpine landscape. Fresh, lively and closely connected to local grape varieties, they demonstrate why Savoie is attracting growing interest from wine drinkers looking for wines with a strong sense of place and a character of their own.



The Apremont vineyards in France's Savoie region



Domaine Viallet in the foothills of the French Alps

- **NV Viallet Crémant de Savoie**

A sparkling wine made in the style of Champagne, this is light and refreshing, dry and crisp with tiny bubbles. At $13 a bottle it is an incredible bargain.

- **2024 G.G. Bouvet Roussette de Savoie**

This is another of the Viallet labels and Roussette is their name for the Altesse grape. It is a charming white wine, clean and crisp with floral notes of honeysuckle and orange blossoms. On the palate it shows peach and apricot flavors. Perfect aperitif.

- **2024 Vialet Chignin-Bergeron**

Chignin-Bergeron is the name in Savoie for the Roussanne grape from the Rhone Valley. It is my favorite of the Savoie wines. Richer and fuller and round in the mouth with good weight and structure. Flavors of melons and pears and a long lingering finish. Excellent effort.

- **2023 Clos de la Galeze Mondeuse**

Mondeuse is related to the Syrah grape and makes the best red wines in the Savoie. It is medium-bodied with flavors of cherries and currants and moderate tannins. It has ample acid and should drink well for five years.



Thomas Chifflot provided the hospitality at Domaine Viallet.

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PUP TALKS

The price of the prize: Why AKC dog sports are slowly dying



Coral the Great Dane poses for the judge, her handler hoping for a win after paying high entry fees.

By Sierra Berrick

The world of competitive dog sports can be one of the most exciting for canine enthusiasts. There is the opportunity to meet fellow dog lovers, win awards for your pup, and spend quality time with them. Unfortunately, fewer and fewer new people are joining. Let's examine a couple of reasons that may explain this, and hopefully drive current professionals in the American Kennel Club (AKC) world to make some changes.

Not everything is the fault of individuals, but of our infrastructure. Simply put, money is an issue. With the costs of operating training clubs and events going up just like the cost of living, many people are being priced out of dog shows. To enter a dog in AKC conformation, the majority of shows cost around $37 a day. To compete in a four-day show, that's well over $100, not counting the cost of travel and food. Even newer sports, such as Fast CAT, demonstrate significant costs on their entry forms. In California, pre-entry for Fast CAT, which allows two runs per dog per day, costs between $28 and $35 per run. Considering this sport is entirely based on participation, the unfortunate truth is that people are now paying for their titles rather than needing to demonstrate excellence with their dog. For young people who may have bachelor's-degree-level jobs, these prohibitively high entry fees make it impossible for them to get their foot in the door.

Lack of new exhibitors is a big concern, not just because it means dog shows are slowly becoming an event only for the wealthy, but because fewer competitors means fewer championship points and majors. The AKC point system is based on winning against a certain number of dogs, and with more competitors aging out than entering the sport, it will become markedly harder for individuals to achieve championship titles with their dogs.

Now let's talk about attitude. Many people coming from pet backgrounds assume that all dog people are enthusiastic and kind. Unfortunately, this is not always so within the dog show world. Many new participants at dog shows report feeling unwelcome and unsupported. Although there is no clear reason for this, the idea of people simply being competitive does not fully explain it.

The high costs of entry, plus feeling excluded by veterans in the sport, unfortunately lead many new exhibitors to quit before they've really started. This means that it is up to the old-timers in dog sports to open their hearts to new competitors, and for new competitors to set the tone in the sport as welcoming going forward. Perhaps the American Kennel Club should consider the long-term results of pricing out exhibitors with these high entry fees. Only time will tell if dog enthusiasts are able to commit to these necessary changes.

Sierra Berrick is a professional dog trainer and AKC Evaluator located in Oakland, California. She helped to launch the service dog and facility dog training organization Alpha Dog Assist in Mill Valley in 2021 and currently offers private training in service dog work, obedience, and behavioral consultation. To contact her, please call 510-507-2017, email Sierra109@gmail.com, or visit her website at www.oakhillsdogtraining.weebly.com.

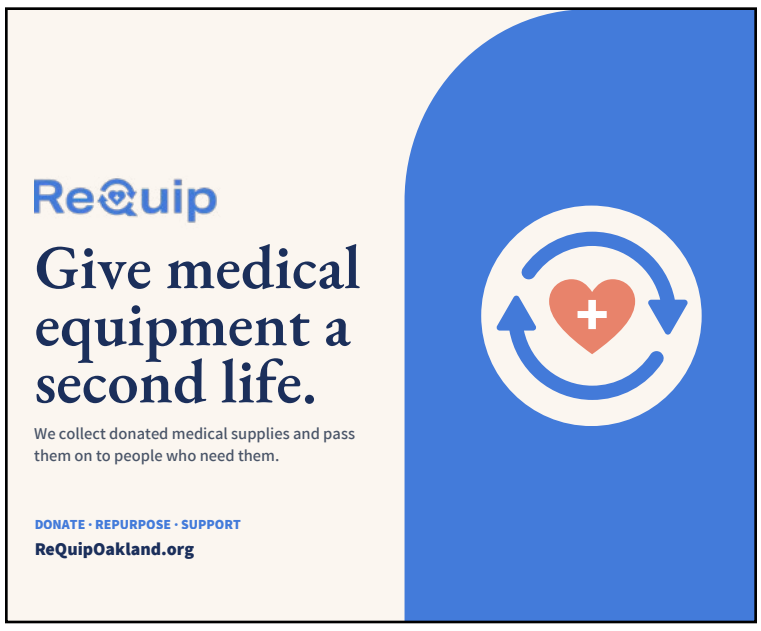
New nonprofit with Piedmont connection

By Christy Guidici

A new Oakland nonprofit, ReQuip, is giving gently used medical equipment and supplies a second life, while making those resources available free of charge to people throughout the community. The organization was created to address two needs at once: improving access to essential medical equipment and keeping usable medical resources out of the landfill.

ReQuip collects, sanitizes and redistributes gently used medical equipment and supplies to individuals who need them. Community members can donate items they no longer need, while people who need equipment for themselves or a family member, are welcome to access the available resources at no cost. It is a place to donate and a resource for anyone who needs these items.

ReQuip accepts a wide range of gently used medical equipment and supplies, including four-wheeled walkers, wheelchairs, continence supplies, bandages, wound care products, braces, shower seats, and other usable medical resources. Information about ReQuip, what can and cannot be accepted, and the mission statement, is available on the website, ReQuipoakland.org. And of course, it would be lovely to have you come volunteer.



Donate gently used medical equipment and supplies to ReQuip.org

The organization was founded on the belief that medical equipment that is no longer of use to one person, can tremendously benefit the next person, while reducing waste, and strengthening community health and independence.

ReQuip will open its doors October 13, and will be open every Tuesday from 10:00 a.m. - 2:00p.m. ReQuip is located in the Oakland Peace Center, 111 Fairmount Avenue at 29th Street. (Look for the blue-wall patio on the right). ReQuipoakland.org

READ IT IN THE *POST*

Obituary

J. Ronald Pengilly

5/5/1934- 9/28/2026



Long time Piedmont resident J. Ronald (Ron) Pengilly passed at the age of 92.

J. Ronald (Ron) Pengilly passed peacefully on September 28, 2026. Ron was born on May 5, 1934 to Joseph and Lillian Pengilly in Montebello, CA where he was raised. He leaves behind his beloved wife of 67 years, Margaret Ann (Margy) Pengilly, his daughter, Kathryn Ann Pengilly, son James W. Pengilly and seven grandchildren.

Ron was a straight A student throughout high school and college. He attended UCLA where he was a member of the Phi Beta Kappa academic honorary society and the Phi Gamma Delta fraternity while participating in student government. Boalt Law School (now named UC Berkeley Law) came next. While at Boalt he won the state Moot Court championship. During his law school years, he worked as a "hasher" at the Kappa Alpha Theta sorority where he met his future wife, Margy.

They were married in 1959 after they both graduated. In 1961, they moved to Piedmont where they raised their children and have lived for over 60 years.

Ron joined a small law firm in San Francisco after passing the bar in 1959. He was only the 5th person to join. The firm grew rapidly and changed names several times and expanded nation and worldwide. Pettit and Martin became its permanent name.

Ron's specialty was real estate law at which he excelled. Examples of his successes include the Transamerica Pyramid, Rossmoor, and the relocation of the San Francisco produce market. He loved his law practice.

In retirement he enjoyed having more time to be with his family, traveling, reading, and playing bridge and golf with friends.

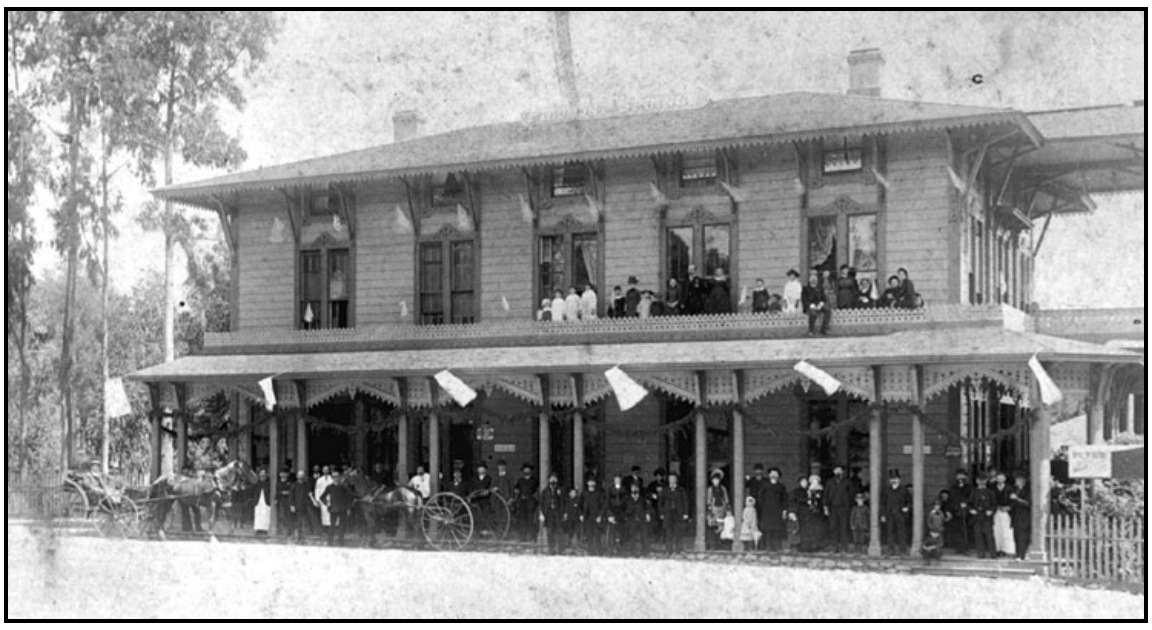
Private services for the family will be held.

For those who have asked please make donations to the charity of your choice.



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Contact Janet Epstein, Coordinator:
jepstein@piedmont.ca.gov or
Piedmont Recreation Department: 510.420.3070

The History of Piedmont



Guests, visitors and staff lined up in front of the Piedmont Springs Hotel for this undated photo, possibly the grand opening in 1871.



A map shows the location of Piedmont Springs Hotel and Sulphur Springs at the end of Vernal Avenue (now Highland Avenue) in 1883.

Piedmont Springs Hotel, circa 1871

By Gail G. Lombardi

Part 2 in a series

It all started with the water. It smelled awful, but it made his old joints feel better. In the mid-1850s, old Isaac Holmes dragged a bathtub down the ravine to the mineral springs on the side of the hill. Soaking in the mineral water helped to ease his rheumatism. When he died, the mineral springs were forgotten.

In the 1860s, these mineral springs (said to contain sulphur, magnesia, iodine and iron) were re-discovered in the ravine behind today's Exedra, the current location of Bushy Dell Creek. Drinking or soaking in mineral water was believed to have great curative powers. These mineral springs were similar to the popular mineral waters in Calistoga, *and* they were only three miles from downtown Oakland.

Investors quickly saw an opportunity to develop the springs and build a hotel to accommodate visitors who came to "take the waters." They selected the name "Piedmont," meaning "foot of the hills," thus securing the name of Piedmont to our locale. The investors formed the Piedmont Land Company to buy 350 acres around the ravine, build the hotel and sell any adjoining land not needed for the hotel purposes as residential lots.

In 1871, the Piedmont Springs Hotel opened near today's Exedra as a first-class resort. The photo of the hotel shows only the northern portion of the building, which had two wings and was twice the size of the building as shown.

The hotel had a wide veranda, 20 first-class bedrooms and two suites, five dining rooms, telegraph service, and a Grand Saloon (for men only) with an elegant mahogany bar, billiard table, spittoons and a pot-bellied stove. The ladies' entrance allowed women to enter the hotel, avoid the saloon and proceed directly to the main dining room with its crystal chandelier, linen tablecloths and fine china.

The hotel quickly became a popular destination and drew visitors who passed a pleasant Sunday at Piedmont Springs, strolling the meandering paths to the mineral springs and enjoying an excellent lunch or dinner. The dining rooms served fresh meat from nearby ranches, milk and butter from Blair's Dairy, and fresh fruit and vegetables from its gardens. The hotel also offered fine wine and liquor for those who did not care for mineral water. Fashionable San Franciscans would come for a week to escape the summer fog. Many hotel guests enjoyed the mild weather and views of San Francisco Bay and decided to buy land and build their homes here.

The hotel thrived until 1892, when a spark from a faulty chimney started a fire on the roof. Hotel guests watched helplessly as the hotel burned to the ground before firefighters could arrive from downtown Oakland. The site would not be empty for long... but that's another story.

The mineral springs are still in Piedmont Park, but they were capped in the 1950s because the sulphur fumes offended many residents. The historical marker at the Veterans' Building gives the location of the springs.

To learn more about Piedmont's history, see the Piedmont Historical Society website: Piedmonthistorical.org.

Originally printed in the Piedmont Post on March 28, 2018.



Mark Twain (left of center holding ladle) visited Piedmont's mineral springs in the 1860s.

Real Estate

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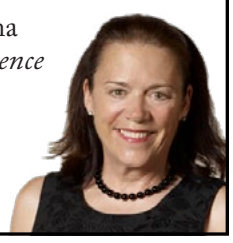
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STARR★SCHAEFER Report

Your monthly go-to for real estate market trends, market stats & mortgage money matters

Happy Fall, all!

THE VALUE OF LOCAL REPRESENTATION:

An exceptionally strong class of motivated buyers is fueling heavy demand in Piedmont right now, proving that the fall market remains a fantastic opportunity to sell before the season winds down for winter. This localized window offers sellers a great time to achieve excellent results with careful preparation and local expertise.

For buyers, navigating our fast-moving, highly competitive market is always easier with local representation by your side. Working with a local agent brings a few distinct advantages:

- **Exclusive Insight:** Local agents are often the first to know about unique opportunities around town, including quiet, off-market properties.
- **Intimate Inventory Knowledge:** They tour the inventory firsthand and know recent neighborhood sales that make good comparables, often with in-depth knowledge of properties and their condition to help put a new listing's true value into perspective.
- **Good Neighbors:** Over the years, local agents build real friendships and trust with colleagues across different brokerages. When things get competitive, that mutual respect and track record of smooth closings can be the comfort a listing agent needs to help choose your offer.

MORTGAGE MONEY

Our "go-to" Mortgage Money Broker, **BRADY THOMAS, LA SALLE MORTGAGE,** has this to share this month:

Mortgage rates have moved sharply higher over the past month, and last week the Federal Reserve raised rates for the first time in more than three years. With inflation heating back up, energy costs rising and the war with Iran continuing, homeowners should be prepared for mortgage rates to stay higher for longer.

From my seat as a mortgage lender, higher rates are becoming just as much a seller problem as a buyer problem. I'm talking with more buyers who recognize that when a home needs work, has been sitting, or is priced too aggressively, they have leverage. Instead of simply asking for a lower price, buyers are more frequently negotiating seller credits that can be used to lower their mortgage rate or cover closing costs. This is often the most effective way to bridge the affordability gap. Sellers with the best homes may not need to make these concessions, but everyone else should understand that buyers will increasingly look to sellers for help with the economic pain in the mortgage markets.

MARKET OVERVIEW: 9/1/26-9/30/26

SOLDS: 16

Lowest: 220 Moraga., listed for $1,095,000, sold for $1,450,000, number of offers: 5

Highest: 305 Sheridan Ave., listed for $6,398,000, sold for $7,250,000, number of offers: 2

CURRENT PENDINGS: 12

Lowest: 72 Portsmouth, listed for $1,449,000, number of offers: 4

Highest: 331 Hillside Ave., listed for $10,950,000

CURRENT ACTIVE & COMING SOON LISTINGS: 9

Lowest: 1520 Grand Ave., listed for $1,599,999

Highest: 280 Indian Road, listed for $22,500,000

For more than four decades, our team has been trusted for real estate guidance in our unique market. We are always happy to be of service and answer any questions you may have.

See you next month!

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Karen Starr | 510-414-6000 | DRE# 01111458
Brenda Schaefer | 510-453-2401 | DRE# 01896001
The Grubb Company
(Please note that not all listings mentioned were listed by the Grubb Co.)

PPD Blue

Continued from page 11

Friday, October 2

1:15 a.m. Monticello Ave. **Arrest.** Report of two people in verbal argument. Officer on scene, one subject found to be on probation out of Sacramento County for possession of drugs, a stolen vehicle and burglary. Officers find person to be in possession of narcotics and drug paraphernalia. Person arrested for violation of probation terms and taken to Santa Rita Jail, Rejected at jail & transported to hospital.

6:16 a.m. Cambridge Way. **Vandalism.** Report of attempted catalytic converter theft. Converter cut but not removed.

8:41 a.m. Somerset Rd. **Residential Burglary.** Report of home under construction broken into overnight. Tools stolen.

ADVERTISE IN THE *POST*

Letters to the Editor

Continued from page 3

helpful to have leaders who are good listeners, thoughtful, and creative problem solvers. Bill's ability to listen, to work well with others and his dedication make him an unusually effective leader.

Please join us in casting an enthusiastic and appreciative YES vote for Bill Reichle.

Sincerely,
Sarah Pearson & Evan Seevak
147 Arbor Drive, Piedmont

Nancy Beninati for City Council

To the Editor,

I am writing to support Nancy Beninati for Piedmont City Council.

As a 15 year resident of Piedmont, a local real estate agent, and Head Coach of the Piedmont Mountain Bike Team, I have had the opportunity to see Nancy's commitment to Piedmont firsthand through her involvement as a parent/coach with our team.

Nancy is smart, hardworking, and dedicated. When she has questions about an issue affecting our community, she asks questions, does her research, and takes the time to understand the full picture. I tremendously respect her thoughtful and responsible approach. I am most proud of the culture of our mountain biking team. A big part of that culture comes from people like Nancy and her family that support and encourage the rest of the community. Culture is built with intentionality, and Nancy knows that full well.

I enthusiastically support Nancy for City Council. I believe her experience, judgment, and commitment to Piedmont will make her a strong member of our City Council.

Jon Reining
Piedmont

Bill Reichle for City Council

Editor,

We proudly support the candidacy of Bill Reichle for City Council. As Piedmont residents for nearly 50 years, we've always been grateful for the dedicated service of our elected public officials — the people who step up to run for challenging offices, and the people with the integrity and the competence so critically needed to get important community work done, and done right.

Bill Reichle has our enthusiastic support because he represents the finest example of one of those step-up people: Motivated by nothing more than a wish to give back to his community, he accepts no outside donations and is self-funding his campaign. Just as important, he brings to his candidacy a rare set of critical skills for the Council post — an even and generous personality, and an unequaled career background in administrative management. No surprise, then, that Reichle's candidacy has been endorsed not only by Piedmont's current mayor, but by eight former mayors, as well.

Beyond all that, Bill Reichle has developed a thoughtfully progressive program that emphasizes Public Safety, Fiscal Discipline, and Community Engagement. We urge you to check it out in detail at ReichleforPiedmont.com.

Tim and Marian Nelson
237 Scenic Avenue

Endorsing Adam Hundt for City Council

Editor,

I am writing to endorse Adam Hundt for Piedmont City Council. I first met Adam while assisting him with his home search in Piedmont. During that process, I quickly came to appreciate his gentle, thoughtful manner and the respectful way he communicated his priorities, traits that I believe are essential for local leadership.

Adam is an exceptional candidate whose unique, highly relevant perspective makes him a strong asset for our city. His impressive academic background includes a bachelor's degree from Brown, an MBA, a master's in industrial engineering from the University of Michigan, and a master's in public policy from Johns Hopkins with a focus on clean energy. This rigorous educational foundation underscores both his sharp intelligence and his drive.

Adam and his wife are raising their two young children here, and one of them attends Havens Elementary. His interest in local government grew from a desire to help Piedmont increase energy efficiency, an initiative that would lower our carbon footprint while boosting property values. Both are critical. While these issues inspired his run, his vision for our city is much broader.

While the Hundt family is relatively new to Piedmont, I deeply respect Adam's commitment to getting involved and sharing his professional expertise. We need the fresh perspectives and energy that young families bring to navigate the complex issues ahead, and I believe Adam Hundt is exactly the kind of leader who will serve our community well.

–Pamela Strike Fullerton,
Realtor
Ramona Ave.

Support Nancy Beninati for City Council

To the Editor:

I am writing to support Nancy Beninati for Piedmont City Council. I have known Nancy for more than a decade, and over the years I have had many opportunities to see firsthand her commitment to our community.

I met Nancy through the Piedmont League of Women Voters where she served as President. Nancy put a tremendous amount of time and energy into leading the League. She worked hard to make sure the League provided our community with thoughtful, balanced opportunities to learn about important issues and participate in local government. She was organized, prepared, and consistently went above and beyond in serving our community.

Having served on the Piedmont Unified School Board for eight years, I understand the commitment that public service requires. I have seen that same commitment in Nancy. She brings decades of public and community service experience, a willingness to listen and learn, and a genuine commitment to Piedmont and its residents. I know she will bring those qualities to her work on the City Council.

I am proud to support Nancy and hope you will join me in voting for her for City Council.

Cory Smegal
Former Piedmont Board of Education President
2025 Arthur Hecht Volunteer of the Year

Bonnie Tam

Continued from page 1

ence and the judgment to hit the ground running from day one."

As Public Works Director in San Fernando, Tam led a full-service department and oversaw a $46 million Capital Improvement Program, including major infrastructure projects across water treatment, parks, and public facilities. Previously, at the City of Ontario, Tam oversaw a $690 million five-year Capital Improvement Program and led major initiatives including implementing an agency-wide asset management program.

Her municipal career also includes service with the cities of Monterey Park and Long Beach. Tam joins Piedmont at an important moment. The City has substantial needs across aging infrastructure and facilities. Meeting those needs will require careful prioritization, strategic use of local dollars, and maximizing opportunities to leverage outside resources.

Tam cites Piedmont's engaged community as a major factor in her decision, saying "I was drawn to Piedmont because it is a close-knit community where people care deeply about their city and are involved in how it moves forward. My approach is centered on communication and collaboration – listening to residents, working across departments, and identifying and solving problems early."

"I look forward to working with my colleagues and the community to preserve what makes Piedmont special while continuing to elevate the infrastructure and services residents rely on every day," Tam said.

Tam holds a Master of Public Administration from the University of Southern California and a bachelor's degree in Criminology, Law and Society from the University of California, Irvine. The City engaged Bob Murray & Associates to conduct the recruitment following the departure of former Public Works Director Daniel Gonzales. Rich Cunningham has served as Interim Public Works Director in Piedmont since former director Daniel Gonzales departed,

The salary for the Public Works Director is $237,029. This position includes reimbursement for professional development, a monthly auto allowance, and standard benefits associated with management team. These benefits include bereavement leave, personal leave, vacation leave, sick leave, and recognized holidays.

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Candidates' Q&A

Continued from page 1

Nancy Beninati
(NancyforPiedmont.com)

I support and appreciate the hard work of our police, fire, and city employees. I believe all Piedmont employees should be paid fairly and competitively, consistent with what the City can responsibly afford.

The City must carefully evaluate any proposals and the long-term fiscal impacts to make a decision that best serves our community as a whole. While Piedmont has some wealthy residents, the City's revenue streams are limited and rely heavily on property taxes. Any significant increase in compensation or benefits must be considered in the context of the entire City budget, the needs of all City employees, and other important City priorities.

I support Measure GG because it would provide the City with additional ongoing revenue for parks, recreation, infrastructure, maintenance, and other City needs, including employee compensation. But additional revenue does not eliminate the need to make difficult budget choices.

As a councilmember, I would support fair compensation while also making sure that any agreement is financially sustainable and treats all of our employees fairly. Ultimately, the Council and City will have to balance competitive compensation with the City's overall financial constraints and the priorities of the community.

Adam Hundt
(AdamHundt.com)

The City Council should present to the community a comprehensive plan for the police and fire departments. We need to maintain these services for the future in a way that is fair to the union members and ensures that the departments are adequately funded. Currently, overtime salaries are 136% of the amount approved for the budget year (a cost increase of $927,150). This is not sustainable for overtime firefighters or for the city.

Is the solution increasing the number of staff, changing the shift schedule, altering the duties (in addition to extinguishing fires, Piedmont firefighters are also trained as EMTs or paramedics), or something else? I believe everyone in the community deserves adequate health care. The plan the Council should produce must assure health benefits for the union and every other city employee.

Finally, we should explore ways to provide housing for Piedmont city employees. One way to do this is to work with developers to build below-market-rate units specifically for municipal employees such as firefighters, police, and teachers. I'm eager to work on this plan, and I promise to submit it to the whole community for comment.

Sunny Bostrom-Fleming

One of the main benefits of living in Piedmont is public safety. Protecting the lives of our families and our pets is our number one priority; our property can be replaced, but the lives we cherish cannot. While we are all very proud of both our police and fire departments, we must maintain a competitive workplace for these fine people.

Our current focus is the fire department. Where do we get the operator funds to make sure we are a very competitive community? Every day when they leave their homes they have no guarantee of returning alive or uninjured. Measure GG, which is vital to keeping our community financially sound, could go a long way toward funding the fire department. I want us to consider additional funding, such as the schools have with the Giving Campaign.

Seeing how we are surrounded by one of the most dangerous cities in America, Oakland reported 35,096 crimes in 2024: 6,000-plus auto burglaries, 1,100 residential burglaries, and 86 murders. Piedmont had 76 burglaries, one assault, and over 70 stolen cars. Our police and fire professionals are our first line of defense. The officers of Rome who led from the front lines earned their rank through merit and bravery.

Tom Ramsey
Incumbent
(vote4tomramsey.com)

Piedmont's first responders are hometown heroes. While many families move here for the schools, we all value our top-quality police and firefighters who keep us safe every day.

As a small town, Piedmont is in a tough spot to match compensation packages offered by larger cities or towns that benefit from bigger budgets and commercial tax revenue. For decades, Piedmont navigated this position by determining salary levels through an independent third-party that conducts a salary survey comparing total compensation for each role against 13 Bay Area cities identified as comparable to Piedmont. Pay rates for each role are set based on the median compensation.

Recruitment challenges are regional, and responsible budgeting requires balancing new requests such as increased healthcare benefits with existing city obligations, where retiree and current employee medical premiums already cost the city $4 million annually.

I acknowledge this process is taking too long, and it weighs heavily on all involved. I am committed to continuing transparent, good-faith dialogue through our established bargaining representatives to reach a sustainable agreement that is both fair to all employees and fiscally responsible to the community.

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LWVP Forum

Continued from page 1

candidates were numbered 1 through 5, and the moderator called on them at random to answer each question. The candidates had a minute and a half to answer each question.

The questions were chosen from a public submission form and reviewed to ensure a wide range of topics. The forum asked candidates questions about Piedmont's community, the budget, capital projects, infrastructure, disaster preparedness, and Automated Licence Plate Reader (ALPR) camera privacy.

At the end of the questioning period, each candidates presented a one-minute closing statement describing why Piedmont citizens should vote for them and directed the audience to resources that would inform them of their positions.

To watch the full forum and hear the candidates' responses, readers can go to the LWVP's YouTube channel: https://www.youtube.com/@lwvpiedmont/featured.

Visit the Election Resources page (https://bit.ly/4ymy5xS) to learn about what's on the ballot and how, when, and where to vote. Ballots started going out to every registered voter on October 5. Ballot drop-off locations will open October 6. If you have moved or changed your party or your name, you can update your registration online. The last day to register to vote is October 19.



Candidate Sunny Bostrom-Fleming was the first to give an opening statement.



Candidate and incumbent Tom Ramsey



Candidate Bill Reichle



Candidate Nancy Beninati



Candidate Adam Hundt

Candidates' Scorecard Week 6

Candidates	Top 3 issues facing Piedmont	Top 3 infrastructure needs	Moraga Canyon Specific Plan: What would you need to see in it before voting yes?	Do you support the Fire Dept. union's requests for increased benefits?
Sunny Bostrom-Fleming	*No response received*	Street and sidewalk paving and improving police, fire, and school infrastructure.	We need massive community input to ensure that if this area is developed, we keep our citizens, our children, our pets, and wildlife safe.	Would use revenue from Measure GG to help to fund increased benefits for the department.
Bill Reichle	Moraga Canyon housing, sustainability, and updating century-old city facilities	Street paving, ADA upgrades, and updating older city buildings	My focus would be on public safety, traffic circulation, emergency evacuation, pedestrian and bicycle safety, and wildfire mitigation.	Would use Measure GG revenue to help fund the fire department and help Piedmont compete in a competitive employment market.
Nancy Beninati	Public Safety, Good Governance, Preserving Community and Sustainability	Maintaining streets and sidewalks, upgrading stormwater systems, and modernizing public facilities	Delivers the required affordable housing, is financially and legally sound, and enhances the community.	Supports fair compensation while also making sure that any agreement is financially sustainable and treats all employees fairly.
Adam Hundt	Affordable electrification and energy-efficient home upgrades, building new homes, and raising city revenue	Mitigating risk from hazards that could affect residents' housing, and maintaining roads and bike pathways	AC Transit service and road traffic. Ensure noise levels are controlled in compliance with wildfire safety protocols, and preserve Coaches Field and the Corporation Yard	The City Council should present to the community a comprehensive plan for the police and fire departments. Maintain services in a way that is fair to the union members and ensures that the departments are adequately funded.
Tom Ramsey (*Incumbent*)	Community safety, fiscal responsibility, and maintaining the beauty of our town	Sewers and storm drains, pavement management, and aging civic buildings	I would need to see a clear commitment to the vision our community developed through numerous public workshops, commission reviews, and formal hearings.	Committed to continuing transparent, good-faith dialogue to reach a sustainable agreement that is both fair to all employees and fiscally responsible to the community.

All candidates support Measure GG

Athletes of the Month

Continued from page 12

Honorable Mentions

Maddy Huynh earns an honorable mention for making a huge impact on the girls' tennis varsity roster as a freshman, typically appearing at No. 3 singles, which a few appearances in the No. 2 spot. In September, the freshman won eight matches and lost just twice – both of which went to an extra third set.

Dylan Jerez earns an honorable mention for his instant impact on the boys' water polo team as their starting goalie as a sophomore. He had 12 saves, a steal, and assist in Piedmont's 14-6 win over Encinal, 10 saves and five assists in a 15-11 win over Bishop O'Dowd on September 4, and nine saves in their 8-7 double overtime loss to James Logan on September 3.



Sophomore Dylan Jerez earns an honorable mention for his impact as the new water polo goalie.

Tennis

Continued from page 13

Chan and Silvio lost 6-3, 7-6 (8-6) at No. 1 doubles, and Faith Chin fell 6-4, 6-2 at No. 2 singles.

It all came down to Ruthven at No. 1 singles, but she fell in a close three-set match, 6-2, 4-6, 10-7.

6-1 over Castro Valley

Piedmont won three of four singles matches. Ruthven won 6-1, 6-2 at the No. 1 spot, while Faith Chin won by the same score, 6-1, 6-2 at No. 2. Huynh won in a 6-0, 6-0 sweep at No. 3, but Sharafi lost 6-2, 6-1 at No. 4.

The Highlanders won all three doubles matches. Chan and Silvio won in three sets at the No. 1 spot, 6-4, 6-7 (7-5), 10-6. Reed-Miguel and Pham won 6-1, 6-1 at No. 2, and Welch and Oldrin won 6-3, 6-0 at No. 3.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (9-4 overall, 3-0 league) visits Justin Siena in Napa on Wednesday, October 14.

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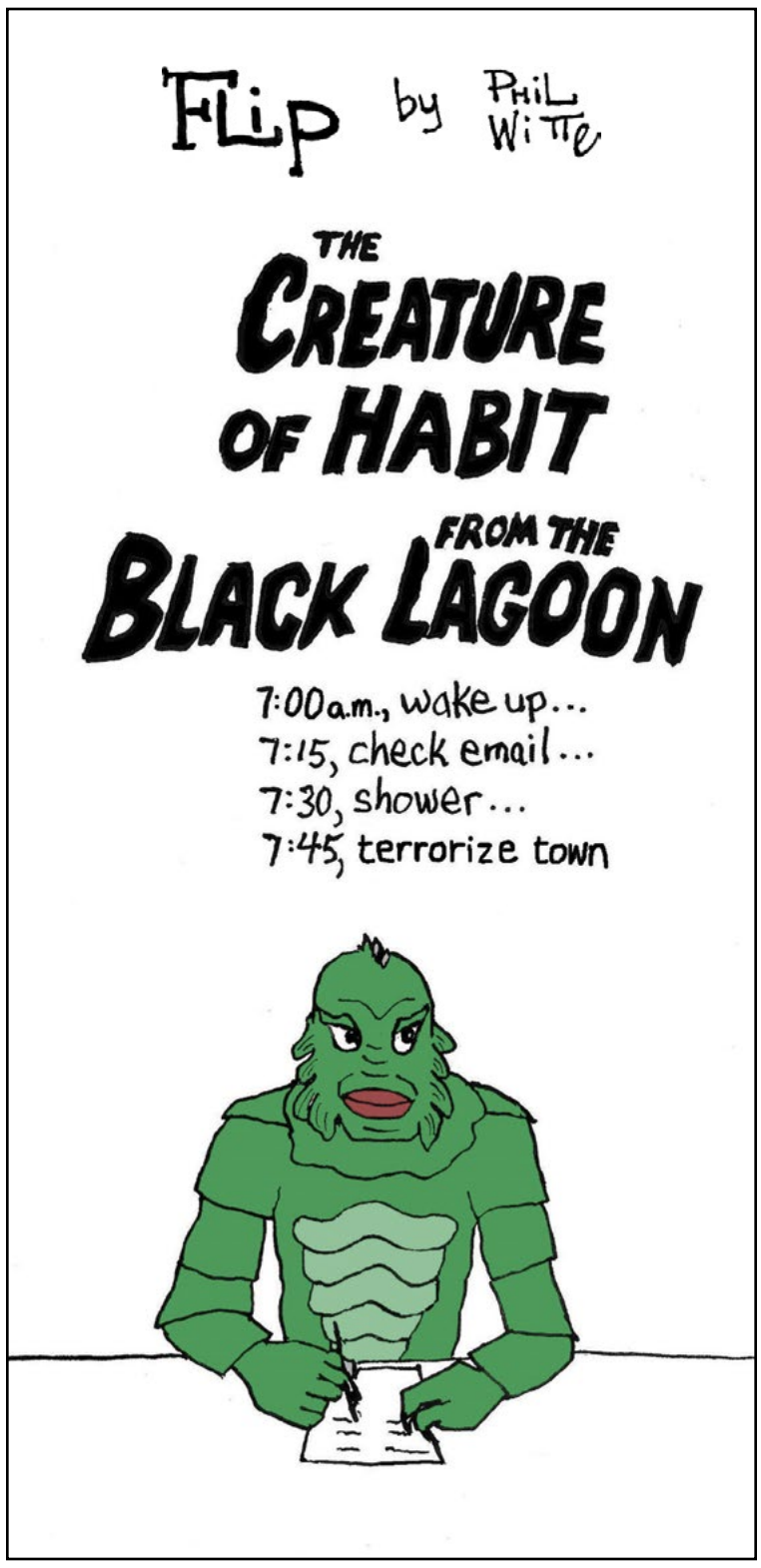
October 7 - October 14

Wednesday, October 7
5:30 p.m. ..... Park Commission meeting ..... City Hall

Monday, October 12
5:30 p.m. ..... Planning Commission meeting ..... City Hall

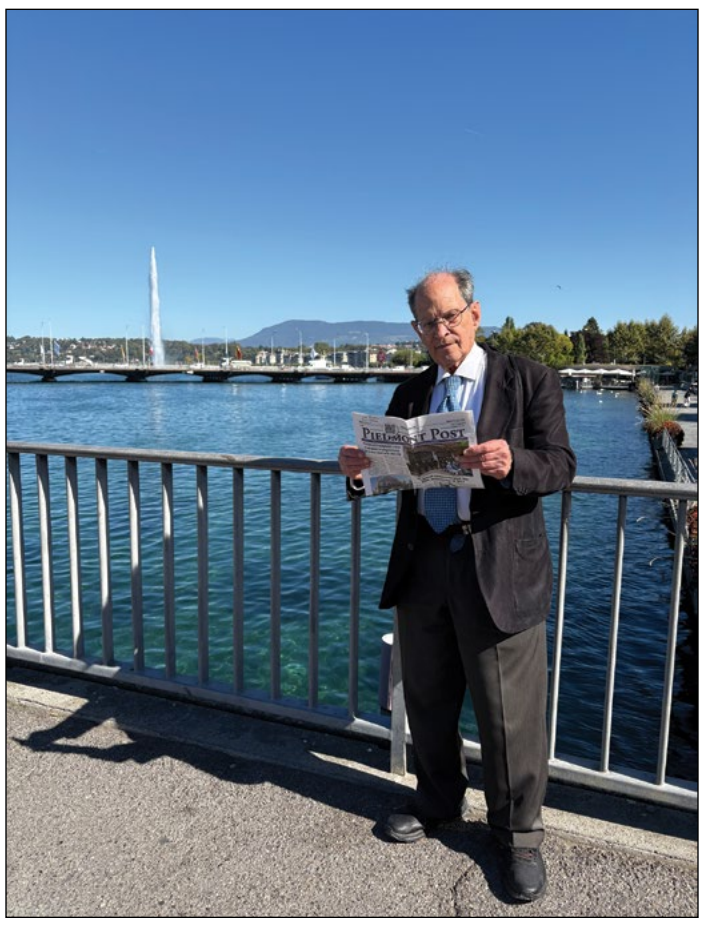
Wednesday, October 14
7:00 p.m. ..... Board of Education meeting ..... City Hall

Meetings may be viewed on KCOM (Channel 27) and on the City's website: piedmont.ca.gov.



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Piedmont Post columnist Joseph Gold in Geneva, Switzerland, on the shores of Lake Geneva with its famous fountain in the background. He is reading his favorite newspaper.

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